

Symphony: Scalable SNARKs in the Random Oracle Model from Lattice-Based High-Arity Folding

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Abstract

Folding schemes are a powerful tool for building scalable proof systems. However, existing folding-based SNARKs require embedding hash functions (modeled as random oracles) into SNARK circuits, introducing both security concerns and significant proving overhead.

We re-envision how to use folding, and introduce **Symphony**, the first folding-based SNARK that avoids embedding hashes in SNARK circuits. It is memory-efficient, parallelizable, streaming-friendly, plausibly post-quantum secure, with poly-logarithmic proof size and verification, and a prover dominated by committing to the input witnesses.

A core component of our construction is a new lattice-based folding scheme that compresses *a large number* of NP-complete statements into one *in a single shot*. Furthermore, we design a generic compiler that converts a folding scheme into a SNARK without embedding the Fiat-Shamir circuit into proven statements. Our evaluation shows its concrete efficiency, making **Symphony** a promising candidate for applications such as zkVM, proof of learning, and post-quantum aggregate signatures.

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1 Introduction

Succinct non-interactive arguments of knowledge (SNARKs) allow a prover to convince weak devices that a computation was performed correctly using only a short proof. It has enabled new applications such as scaling and securing blockchain [Whi18; Xio+23], digital provenance [NT16; DB22; KHSS22; DCB25], verifiable machine learning [CWSK24; YCBC24], verifiable delay functions [BBBF18], etc. While many efficient SNARKs were introduced [BBHR18; AHIV17; Ben+19; Gol+23; ZCF24; Bre+25; COS20; BS23; ACFY25], they require massive memory for proving large statements. A memory-efficient framework is to split the computation into small steps and prove each step separately. Two main strategies exist: streaming provers [BCHO22; PP24; Baw+24] and incrementally verifiable computation (IVCs) or proof of carrying data (PCDs). Early IVC/PCD systems rely on recursive SNARKs [Val08; BCTV14], which embed a SNARK verifier into each statement. The recursion imposes prohibitive overhead and remained only of theoretical interest.

Recently, a new framework called accumulation or folding was introduced in Halo [BGH19] and further developed in [BCMS20; Bün+21; BDFG21; KST22]. Folding is a public-coin protocol that reduces the task of checking multiple uniform statements to checking one, and can be made non-interactive via the Fiat-Shamir heuristic. Though weaker than SNARKs without the full succinctness, folding is more concretely efficient and still suffices for IVC/PCDs [Bün+21; KST22].

Before our work, the standard (and the only) approach to use folding to obtain succinct proof systems is by folding *recursive* statements. E.g., in an IVC, at each iteration step, the prover folds an accumulated statement and an online statement to obtain a new accumulated statement, and it generates a new online statement that checks a step function and the correctness of the previous folding step. This technique extends to folding trees (or DAGs) to obtain PCDs. Since folding verifiers are much simpler than SNARK verifiers, this achieves significant speedups over recursive SNARKs. Compared to monolithic SNARKs, folding is more streaming-friendly and allows one to start proving without knowing all witnesses upfront. However, this strategy faces a few key limitations.

Instantiating random oracles. Existing folding schemes require Fiat-Shamir for non-interactivity, and hash-based folding schemes [BMNW25a; BMNW25b; BCFW25] invoke even more hashes for Merkle openings. This leads to both efficiency and security concerns.

Efficiency-wise, the folding verifier logic embeds heavy hashing gadgets: A standard hash gadget takes thousands of R1CS constraints; even a SNARK-friendly hash takes hundreds of constraints. To justify, the Fiat-Shamir circuit is dominant in lattice-based folding schemes [BC24; BC25; NS25]; the verifier for hash-based 2-to-1 folding schemes already takes tens of millions of R1CS constraints.

Security-wise, hash-based SNARKs and the Fiat-Shamir transform are only proven secure in the random oracle model. If we instantiate the oracle with concrete hash

functions and embed it into proven statements, the scheme’s security relies only on heuristic conjectures. Even worse, attacks exist [KRS25] for GKR-based SNARKs if we allow the proven statement to compute the Fiat-Shamir hash function itself.

Limited folding arity. Due to the cost of hashing gadgets, folding typically takes only 2 or 3 inputs per step. Batch proving more input statements then requires deeper folding trees, which degrades parallelism and security. For example, IVCs/PCDs from rewinding-based folding is secure only if the folding depth is a constant, with known attacks to certain schemes for super-logarithmic depths [LS24; BMNW25a]. Some schemes propose folding more inputs per step [Ngu+24; RZ22] but the embedded folding verification circuit becomes more expensive. We thus ask,

Can we obtain memory-efficient folding-based SNARKs with streaming provers, without deep folding trees or instantiating random oracles in SNARK circuits?

1.1 Our Contributions

We re-envision how to use folding. For the first time, we move away from recursive folding and advocate a *high-arity* folding approach. While previously deemed impractical, we introduce a new framework that makes high-arity folding feasible and avoids instantiating random oracles inside SNARK circuits.

Our core technical contribution is a new lattice-based *high-arity* folding scheme. It is plausibly post-quantum secure, with a prover only dominated by committing to the input witnesses, and the verifier dominated by combining the commitments using a random vector generated by the Fiat-Shamir heuristic.

Second, we develop a generic framework that converts a broad class of folding schemes, including all group-based and lattice-based ones, into SNARKs in the *random oracle model*. We do need a proof ensuring the correctness of folding, but it does *not* embed random oracle calls inside the proven statement. In Section 8, we further extend the technique to support higher folding depths.

Evaluation and real-world applications. In Section 7, we present a candidate instantiation of our folding-based SNARKs. It supports efficient proof generation for 2^{16} standard R1CS statements over a 64-bit field, each with over 2^{16} constraints. We expect the resulting proofs to be under 200KB (and under 50KB if post-quantum security is not required), with verification in tens of milliseconds. The prover is memory-efficient, parallelizable, and streaming-friendly, i.e., it can start working as soon as some proven statements are known. (See Remark 4.2 for more details.) The prover cost is dominated only by witness commitments, which takes about $3 \cdot 2^{32}$ multiplications between arbitrary elements and low-norm elements over $R_q := \mathbb{Z}_q[X]/\langle X^{64} + 1 \rangle$. Further speedup is possible if the R1CS witness already has a low ℓ_∞ -norm.

Our framework excels when a *gigantic* proven statement can be decomposed into many *mid-sized* uniform statements, such as in video editing provenance, post-quantum

aggregate signatures, zkVMs, and proof of learning. E.g., Syscoin [Sys26] uses Symphony to shrink SP1 verifier circuit and construct post-quantum witness encryptions; 0xPARC [0xP26] leverages Symphony’s high-arity folding to verify LLM inferences, achieving hundreds-fold proving speedup over monolithic SNARKs.

1.2 Technical Overview

Lattice-based high-arity folding. We first review a standard folding paradigm from linearly homomorphic commitments. Each input is a **committed R1CS statement**¹: the instance consists of a public input $\mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}$ and a commitment c ; the relation checks that a message-opening pair (m, o) is valid for c and that $(\mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}, m)$ satisfies the R1CS constraints. Our lattice-based folding scheme compresses $\ell_{\text{np}} > 1$ R1CS statements in three steps:

1. **Commitment.** The prover commits to the witnesses of the ℓ_{np} statements using a ring/module-based Ajtai commitment [Ajt96; PR06; LM06].
2. **Sumcheck reduction.** Standard techniques [Set20; CBBZ23] transform the R1CS statements to a sumcheck claim. The prover and verifier then run a sumcheck protocol [LFKN92] to reduce the claims into ℓ_{np} linear evaluation statements.
3. **Random linear combination.** The verifier samples a low-norm vector β and linearly combines the instances via β . The prover similarly combines the witnesses. By linearity of the evaluation statements and Ajtai commitments, the committed linear relation is preserved after the linear combination.

However, the key challenge is to prove the *low-norm* property of witness openings. This guaranty is essential for the binding property of Ajtai commitments and for proving the knowledge soundness of the folding scheme.

Our construction is a hybrid scheme of random projection [GHL22; BS23; KLNO25] and the monomial embedding technique [BC25]. Compared to [BC25], we require fewer helper commitments and avoid the need of folding *double commitments*. Compared to [BS23], we improve the verifier time from linear to polylogarithmic in n and leverage folding to achieve better memory efficiency.

Random projection. LaBRADOR [BS23] adapts the technique from [GHL22], reducing the norm-check of a long vector $\mathbf{w}$ to that of a shorter vector $\mathbf{J}\mathbf{w} \bmod q$, where $\mathbf{J} \in \{0, \pm 1\}^{\lambda_{\text{pj}} \times n}$ is a random matrix. Yet, the verifier time is linear in the witness size for generating $\mathbf{J}$. Recently, Kloof et al. [KLNO25] introduces a refinement with sublinear verifiers by using a *structured* projection $\mathbf{J} := \mathbf{I}_{n/\ell_h} \otimes \mathbf{J}'$, where $\mathbf{J}' \in \{0, \pm 1\}^{\lambda_{\text{pj}} \times \ell_h}$ is a narrower random matrix. While elegant, the resulting prover is concretely less efficient, and the verifier checks certain relations *over integers* that are cumbersome to represent as a circuit over finite fields.

¹An R1CS relation is NP-complete and can capture arbitrary computation.

Monomial embedding lookup. To prove that the projected vector $\mathbf{w}' = \mathbf{J}\mathbf{w} \bmod q$ is low-norm, we use the exact range proof from LatticeFold+ [BC25]. Let $R := \mathbb{Z}[X]/\langle X^d + 1 \rangle$ be a power-of-two cyclotomic ring, $R_q := R/qR$, and define a table lookup polynomial $t(X) := \sum_{i \in [1, d/2]} i \cdot (X^{-i} + X^i) \in R_q$. On input a commitment to a vector $\mathbf{f} \in (-d/2, d/2)^n$, the prover sends a commitment to a monomial vector $\mathbf{g} \in R_q^n$, where $\mathbf{g}_i \approx X^{\mathbf{f}_i}$ embeds $\mathbf{f}_i$ onto exponent for all $i \in [n]$. To convince the verifier that $\mathbf{f} \in (-d/2, d/2)^n$, it suffices to show that the constant term of $\mathbf{g}_i \cdot t(X)$ equals $\mathbf{f}_i$ for all $i \in [n]$, which can be efficiently proved using a sumcheck-based protocol. The prover cost is $O(n) R_q$ -additions.

LatticeFold+ actually proves the norm of a *ring* vector $\mathbf{w} \in R^n$, which corresponds to an integer coefficient matrix $\mathbf{W} \in \mathbb{Z}^{n \times d}$. A naive extension would require sending d monomial commitments, leading to large communication and expensive verification. LatticeFold+ addresses this via a *commitment transformation* technique, which requires two extra sumchecks.

The hybrid scheme. In our setting, we only need to check the norm of a *projected* vector $\mathbf{w}' = \mathbf{J}\mathbf{w} \bmod q \in R_q^{n/\ell_h}$, whose coefficient matrix $\mathbf{W}' \in ([-q/2, q/2] \cap \mathbb{Z})^{(n/\ell_h) \times d}$ has smaller dimensions.² By flattening $\mathbf{W}'$ into a vector, we directly apply the monomial embedding protocol *without commitment transformation*. Moreover, the prover only computes $O(1)$ instead of d monomial commitments. By integrating the range proof with the three-step folding framework, we reduce the norm-checks of ℓ_{np} input witnesses into a *single* linear statement. Here, the exact norm check (via monomial lookup) is important to minimize proving cost of the *reduced* statement. Otherwise the reduced statement needs to check the norms of $\ell_{\text{np}} \gg 1$ projected vectors.

Memory and time complexity. As discussed in Remark 4.2, the folding prover can be implemented in a memory-efficient way, requiring space roughly the same as the witness size n of each input statement. As a tradeoff, the algorithm requires $2 + \log \log(n)$ passes over the input data. Designing a one-pass streaming algorithm with comparable prover complexity in the non-recursive setting remains an open problem. The prover time is mainly for computing witness commitments ($O(n) R_q$ -multiplications per input). The verifier circuit complexity is dominated by the Fiat-Shamir heuristic, which is large with high folding arity ℓ_{np} . This makes the standard IVC/PCD compiler infeasible.

From high-arity folding to succinct proofs. We present a new *memory-efficient* paradigm for building folding-based SNARKs without recursively proving hash computations. Naively, given a folding scheme Π_{fold} , we can apply Fiat-Shamir to obtain a non-interactive folding scheme $\text{FS}[\Pi_{\text{fold}}]$ in the random oracle model. However, the folding verifier needs to read at least all of the ℓ_{np} input instances to generate a folding challenge. That already blows up the proof size for large ℓ_{np} . E.g., for $\ell_{\text{np}} = 1000$, the folding proof π easily exceeds 30MB in size with lattice or hash-based schemes.

²As a tradeoff, we only achieve approximate range proofs. But this is sufficient when the folding depth is a small constant.

Another approach is to leverage the commit-and-prove SNARKs (CP-SNARKs) [Kil89; CLOS02; CFQ19]. It is a special class of SNARKs proving that a witness satisfies an NP-relation and is a valid opening to the instance commitments, whereas the CP-SNARK statement itself does *not* need to encode the commitment-opening relation. This leads to the following recursive approach: the prover sends the verifier a *short commitment* c to the ℓ_{np} input instances, then generates CP-SNARK proof showing that the *opening* of c is a list of ℓ_{np} input instances that would pass the folding verification of $\text{FS}[\Pi_{\text{fold}}]$. This approach has a smaller proof and faster verification. However, the *prover* overhead is significant. For $\ell_{\text{np}} = 1000$, the Fiat-Shamir circuit alone needs millions of 2-to-1 hashes over cryptographic fields, with hash-based folding schemes being even worse.

We address the proving inefficiency by moving the Fiat-Shamir outside the recursive statement. This is made possible by letting the verifier run Fiat-Shamir on a *compressed* transcript. The resulting scheme is a variant of the CP-SNARK construction above: instead of directly proving that the openings of c are valid input instances, the prover first sends *short commitments* $\{c_{\text{fs},i}\}_i$ to the prover round messages of Π_{fold} , the verifier then obtains the round challenges using $\{c_{\text{fs},i}\}_i$ (rather than the original prover messages). Finally, the prover generates a CP-SNARK showing that the openings of $\{c_{\text{fs},i}\}_i$ gives a valid folding proof w.r.t. the opening of c and the *public* verifier challenges. Importantly, since the folding challenges are generated by the *verifier*, the CP-SNARK statement does *not* need to prove hash computations!

In [Appendix B](#), we reduce the knowledge soundness of the compiled *non-interactive* protocol ([Section 7](#)) to that of the original interactive protocol Π_{fold} , assuming that the “outer commitment” (for transcript compression) is straightline extractable in idealized models. We view this generic reduction proof as a key innovation over prior works such as lattice double-commitments [BS23; BC25], which also shrink communication by re-committing commitments.

For better succinctness and tighter security reduction, we instantiate the “outer commitments” with Merkle hashes or KZG commitments. Compared to the warm-up, this scheme compresses $> 30\text{MB}$ -sized folding proofs into $\log(n)$ Merkle (or KZG) commitments, under 1KB for most applications. Finally, to be fully succinct, we also need to compress the reduced instance-witness pair $(x_o, w_o) \in \mathcal{R}_o$ of Π_{fold} into a tiny string using standard SNARKs.

Multi-layer folding without recursive circuits. Our instantiation folds 2^{10} R1CS statements over $R_q = \mathbb{Z}_q[X]/\langle X^{64} + 1 \rangle$, equivalent to 2^{16} statements over $\mathbb{Z}_q$. Recent hash-based SNARKs can easily prove more than 2^{24} R1CS constraints in a few seconds. So we can handle more than 2^{40} constraints in total. In principle, even larger arity is possible: e.g., a 2^{14} -way folding batches over a million statements, enough to prove *a billion RISC-V instructions* if each statement covers a thousand instructions. However, higher arity increases norm blowup, forcing larger moduli or lattice dimensions, and requires the CP-SNARK to prove more R_q -multiplications. In certain cases, we might want to increase folding depth to a small constant.

Our scheme extends to higher folding depths. After obtaining the first layer CP-

SNARK proof and the reduced statement $(x_o, w_o) \in \mathcal{R}_o$, we further split (x_o, w_o) to multiple uniform NP statements. Our high-arity folding scheme, combined with the commit-and-prove compiler, then reduces these uniform statements again into a CP-SNARK and a SNARK proof. The final output is two CP-SNARK proofs plus one SNARK proof. Importantly, we still avoid embedding Fiat-Shamir heuristics in circuits. In [Section 8](#), we show how to split (x_o, w_o) when the Ajtai commitment parameter satisfies a structural property.

Extending to other folding schemes. While our compiler naturally extends for elliptic-curve-based folding schemes, it is more nuanced to compile hash-based folding schemes: although we can move the Fiat-Shamir transform outside the recursive SNARK circuit, the CP-SNARK statement still needs to check Merkle-path openings, which accounts for the dominant part of the recursive statement and requires instantiating random oracles. That said, *efficiently* compiling a hash-based folding scheme into a fully succinct proof system in the random oracle model remains an open problem that requires fundamentally new designs.

1.3 Related Work

Lattice double-commitments. Lattice double-commitment schemes such as [\[BS23; BC25\]](#) shrink the Fiat-Shamir transcript by decomposing and re-committing the lattice commitments sent by the prover in each round. Our commit-and-prove compiler shares a structural similarity. However, we take a step further by reducing the *knowledge soundness* of the (non-interactive) commit-and-open scheme ([Section 7](#)) to that of the original *interactive* folding protocol. This reduction is non-trivial (see [Appendix B](#)) and requires the “outer commitment” to be straightline extractable in the idealized model, thus prior lattice security proofs do not fit our folding framework. To meet this requirement, we use Merkle commitments and hash-based CP-SNARKs instead of lattice-based double-commitments. Furthermore, our two-layer folding scheme ([Section 8](#)) introduces a new splitting RoK that reduces a single committed linear statement into multiple “split” statements, which was not known before.

Monolithic CP-SNARKs. Compared to monolithic CP-SNARKs [\[Kil89; CLOS02; CFQ19\]](#), high-arity folding combined with CP-SNARKs is faster, more memory-efficient and streaming-friendly. While CP-SNARKs can already prove ℓ instance-witness pairs in a batch, they require quasilinear proving complexity and suffer from memory requirements proportional to the total witness size $\ell \cdot n$ (where n is the witness length per instance). Our approach sidesteps these bottlenecks by shifting the main computational overhead to the more efficient folding phase, using CP-SNARKs only for a lightweight consistency check between input instances and the folded instance. This reduces memory consumption to $O(n)$ and time complexity down to $O_\lambda(\ell \cdot n)$.

Other related work. There are two main categories of plausibly post-quantum secure folding schemes. Hash-based folding schemes [BMNW25a; BMNW25b; BCFW25] achieve asymptotically fast provers but have expensive folding verifiers due to many Merkle openings. Lattice-based folding schemes [BC24; BC25; NS25; FKNP24] have smaller verifier circuit, but the circuit for the Fiat-Shamir transform is still a bottleneck, which forces them to use low folding arity under the standard IVC/PCD compiler [Bün+21; KST22]. Unfortunately, standard IVC/PCD compilers only allow for constant folding depth, meaning that the resulting schemes can fold at most $O(1)$ statements. Recently, Mangrove [Ngu+24] introduces a more efficient SNARK compiler from folding schemes, but it still requires embedding the entire folding verifier circuit (including FS) into each statement. Chiesa et. al. [CGSY24] provides a tighter security bound for the PCD compiler from recursive SNARKs, though it only applies to SNARKs with straightline extractors.

Several works [CCS22; Che+23] show how to construct PCD in oracle models without instantiating the oracles. However, they rely on the existence of relativized SNARKs, which do not exist in the random oracle model [BCG24].

1.4 Organization

We provide necessary background in Section 2. In Section 3, we introduce a toolbox of protocols that serve as building blocks for our folding scheme. Section 4 presents our high-arity folding scheme that compresses a large number of R1CS statements. Next, Section 6 presents a generic compiler that converts the high-arity folding scheme into a succinct argument. Section 7 gives a candidate instantiation. In Section 8, we extend our scheme to support folding depth two.

2 Preliminaries

Section 2.1 provides necessary algebra background. Section 2.2 describes binding commitments and their instantiations over lattices. Section 2.3 presents the tensor-of-rings framework that enables interleaving between sumcheck and folding operations. Section 2.4 defines generalized reduction of knowledge. Section 2.5 interprets the sumcheck protocol in the language of reduction of knowledge. Finally, Section 2.6 recalls (commit-and-prove) SNARKs.

Notation. $\lambda \in \mathbb{N}$ is the security parameter. A function $f(\lambda)$ is **poly**(λ) if there exists a $c \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $f(\lambda) = O(\lambda^c)$. If $f(\lambda) = o(\lambda^{-c})$ for all $c \in \mathbb{N}$, we say $f(\lambda)$ is in **negl**(λ) and is **negligible**. A probability that is $1 - \text{negl}(\lambda)$ is **overwhelming**. We use logarithm $\log(\cdot)$ to denote $\log_2(\cdot)$. For $l, r \in \mathbb{Z}$, $l < r$, (l, r) denotes the set $\{l+1, l+2, \dots, r-1\}$. We denote by $[l, r) := (l-1, r)$, $[l, r] := [l, r+1)$, and $[n] := [1, n]$. $\mathbb{Z}_q$ denotes the ring of integers modulo q with unique representatives in $[-q/2, q/2) \cap \mathbb{Z}$. For a set S that supports element subtraction, $S - S$ is the set of differences between any two *distinct* elements in S . An **indexed relation** is a set of triples (i, x, w) where

the index $\mathfrak{i}$ is fixed at the setup phase, $\mathfrak{x}$ is the online instance and $\mathfrak{w}$ is the witness. We omit $\mathfrak{i}$ when clear in context.

2.1 Algebra Background

Vectors and matrices. A vector is a column vector by default and a ring is always commutative. For a vector $\mathbf{f}$ of length n and every $i \in [n]$, $\mathbf{f}_i$ or $\mathbf{f}[i]$ denotes the i th element of $\mathbf{f}$. For vectors $\mathbf{f}, \mathbf{g}$ of the same length, their inner product is denoted as $\langle \mathbf{f}, \mathbf{g} \rangle$. $\mathbf{I}_n$ is the identity matrix of rank n . For vectors $\mathbf{u}_1, \dots, \mathbf{u}_k \in \bar{R}^n$ over a ring $\bar{R}$, we denote by $[\mathbf{u}_1, \dots, \mathbf{u}_k] \in \bar{R}^{n \times k}$ and $(\mathbf{u}_1, \dots, \mathbf{u}_k) \in \bar{R}^{nk}$ the horizontal and vertical concatenations. Row vector concatenations are defined similarly. For a matrix $\mathbf{M} \in \bar{R}^{n \times m}$, $\{\mathbf{M}_{i,*} \in \bar{R}^m\}_{i \in [n]}$ and $\{\mathbf{M}_{*,j} \in \bar{R}^n\}_{j \in [m]}$ denote the *rows* and *columns* of $\mathbf{M}$, and $\text{flt}(\mathbf{M}) := (\mathbf{M}_{1,*}, \dots, \mathbf{M}_{n,*}) \in \bar{R}^{nm}$ denotes the vertical concatenation of its rows.

Cyclotomic rings. $R := \mathbb{Z}[X]/\langle X^d + 1 \rangle$ denotes the power-of-two cyclotomic ring of dimension $d = 2^k$. Let $q > 2$ be a prime, $R_q := R/qR = \mathbb{Z}_q[X]/\langle X^d + 1 \rangle$ is the residual ring of R with respect to q . For $f = \sum_{i \in [d]} f_i X^{i-1} \in R_q$, we use $\text{cf}(f) := (f_1, \dots, f_d) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^d$ to denote its coefficient vector, and $\text{ct}(f) := f_1$ is the constant term. For $\mathbf{f} \in R_q^n$, we define its coefficient matrix as $\text{cf}(\mathbf{f}) := (\text{cf}(\mathbf{f}_1)^\top, \dots, \text{cf}(\mathbf{f}_n)^\top) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n \times d}$, and $\text{ct}(\mathbf{f}) = (\text{ct}(\mathbf{f}_1), \dots, \text{ct}(\mathbf{f}_n)) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^n$ is its first column. Conversely, given $\mathbf{f} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^d$ and $\mathbf{F} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n \times d}$, $\text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{f}) \in R_q$ and $\text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{F}) \in R_q^n$ are the ring element and vector such that $\text{cf}(\text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{f})) = \mathbf{f}$ and $\text{cf}(\text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{F})) = \mathbf{F}$.

Norms. The ℓ_2 -norm and ℓ_∞ -norm of a matrix $\mathbf{F} \in \mathbb{Z}^{n \times m}$ are defined as

$$\|\mathbf{F}\|_\infty := \max_{i \in [n], j \in [m]} (|\mathbf{F}_{i,j}|), \quad \|\mathbf{F}\|_2 := \left(\sum_{i \in [n], j \in [m]} \mathbf{F}_{i,j}^2 \right)^{1/2}.$$

The norm of a ring vector $\mathbf{f} \in R^n$ is the norm of $\text{cf}(\mathbf{f}) \in \mathbb{Z}^{n \times d}$. The norm of $\mathbf{F} \in R^{n \times m}$ is the same as the norm of $\text{flt}(\mathbf{F}) \in R^{nm}$. We slightly abuse the notation and define **norms for matrices over R_q (and $\mathbb{Z}_q$)** as the norms of their canonical lifting³ matrices from R_q (and $\mathbb{Z}_q$) to R (and $\mathbb{Z}$). The operator norm of $a \in R$ is

$$\|a\|_{\text{op}} := \sup_{y \in R} \frac{\|a \cdot y\|_2}{\|y\|_2}, \quad (1)$$

and the operator norm $\|\mathcal{S}\|_{\text{op}}$ for a set $\mathcal{S} \subseteq R$ is $\|\mathcal{S}\|_{\text{op}} := \max_{a \in \mathcal{S}} \|a\|_{\text{op}}$. We can similarly define **the operator norm for set $\mathcal{S}$ over R_q** , where for $a \in \mathcal{S} \subseteq R_q$, $y \in R$, the multiplication $a \cdot y \in R$ is over R between y and the canonical embedding of a in R .

We instantiate the **folding challenge set $\mathcal{S}$** as in LaBRADOR [BS23], where each element in $\mathcal{S} \subset R_q := \mathbb{Z}_q[X]/\langle X^{64} + 1 \rangle$ has coefficients in $\{0, \pm 1, \pm 2\}$ and operator norm at most 15. Moreover, elements in $\mathcal{S} - \mathcal{S}$ are invertible over R_q [LS18, Corollary 1.2].

³The canonical embedding maps elements from the quotient ring R_q (and $\mathbb{Z}_q$) to representatives in R (and $\mathbb{Z}$) that have minimal norms.

Gadget decomposition. Fix modulus $q \in \mathbb{N}$, integer base $2 \leq b < q$, and set $k := 1 + \lfloor \log_b(q) \rfloor$. The base- b decomposition $\text{decomp}_{b,k}(\mathbf{f}) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{nk}$ on input $\mathbf{f} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^n$ is defined as follows: for each $i \in [n]$, decompose $\mathbf{f}_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q$ as $\mathbf{g}_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q^k$ such that $\|\mathbf{g}_i\|_\infty \leq b/2$ and $\mathbf{f}_i = \langle \mathbf{g}_i, (1, b, \dots, b^{k-1}) \rangle$. Then $\text{decomp}_{b,k}(\mathbf{f}) := (\mathbf{g}_1, \dots, \mathbf{g}_n) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{nk}$.

Monomial embedding. We review the monomial embedding framework from [BC25], which encodes a bounded integer to a monomial. Define the d -**monomial set**

$$\mathcal{M} := \{0, 1, X, \dots, X^{d-1}\} \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_q[X]. \quad (2)$$

Sometimes we also write $\mathcal{M} \subseteq R_q$ to denote the natural embedding of $\{0, 1, X, \dots, X^{d-1}\}$ to the ring R_q . And $a \in \mathcal{M}$ denotes that $a \in R_q$ is in the embedding set of $\mathcal{M}$ in R_q . We define the **table polynomial**

$$t(X) := \sum_{i \in [1, d/2)} i \cdot (X^i + X^{-i}) = \sum_{i \in [1, d/2)} i \cdot (X^i - X^{d-i}) \in R_q, \quad (3)$$

where the equality holds because $X^d = -1$ over R_q . Intuitively, $t(X)$ embeds the set $(-d/2, d/2)$ onto its coefficients.

For $a \in (-d/2, d/2) \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_q$, $\text{sgn}(a) \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$ is the sign of a and $\text{sgn}(0) := 0$. We define $\text{Exp}(a) := \text{sgn}(a)X^a \in \mathcal{M} \subseteq R_q$ for every $a \in (-d/2, d/2)$. For $\mathbf{M} \in (-d/2, d/2)^{m \times n}$, define

$$\text{Exp}(\mathbf{M}) := (\text{Exp}(\mathbf{M}_{i,j}))_{i \in [m], j \in [n]} \in \mathcal{M}^{m \times n}. \quad (4)$$

We review the following lemma.

Lemma 2.1 (Lemma 2.2 [BC25]). *For all $a \in (-d/2, d/2)$ and $b := \text{Exp}(a)$, we have $\text{ct}(b \cdot t(X)) = a$. Conversely, for all $a \in \mathbb{Z}_q$, if $\text{ct}(b \cdot t(X)) = a$ for some $b \in \mathcal{M}$, then $a \in (-d/2, d/2)$.*

Random projection. We review the random projection lemma from [BS23; GHL22], which states that the ℓ_2 -norm of a vector is preserved after random projection.

Lemma 2.2 (Corollary 3.3 of [GHL22], Lemma 4.2 of [BS23]). *Let χ be a distribution over $\{0, \pm 1\}$ where $\Pr[\chi = 0] = 1/2$ and $\Pr[\chi = -1] = \Pr[\chi = 1] = 1/4$. For all $\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{Z}^n$,*

$$\Pr_{\mathbf{u} \leftarrow \chi^n} [|\langle \mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v} \rangle| > 9.5 \|\mathbf{v}\|_2] \lesssim 2^{-141}. \quad (5)$$

Moreover, let $q \in \mathbb{N}$. For all $B \leq q/125$ and vector $\mathbf{v} \in [-q/2, q/2]^n$ with $\|\mathbf{v}\|_2 > B$,

$$\Pr_{\mathbf{J} \leftarrow \chi^{256 \times n}} \left[\|\mathbf{J}\mathbf{v} \bmod q\|_2 \leq \sqrt{30}B \right] \lesssim 2^{-128}. \quad (6)$$

Coordinate-wise special soundness. Fix $\ell \in \mathbb{N}$ and let $\mathcal{S}$ be a finite set. For two vectors $\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b} \in \mathcal{S}^\ell$, we say that $\mathbf{a} \equiv_i \mathbf{b}$ for $i \in [\ell]$ if $\mathbf{a}_i \neq \mathbf{b}_i$ and $\mathbf{a}_j = \mathbf{b}_j$ for all $j \in [\ell] \setminus \{i\}$.

Lemma 2.3 ([FMN24], Lemma 7.1). Define challenge space $\mathcal{U} := \mathcal{S}^\ell$ and output space $\mathcal{Y}$. Let $\Psi : \mathcal{U} \times \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$ be any predicate. For every probabilistic algorithm $\mathcal{A} : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$, let

$$\epsilon_\Psi(\mathcal{A}) := \Pr_{\mathbf{u} \leftarrow \mathcal{U}} [\Psi(\mathbf{u}, \mathcal{A}(\mathbf{u})) = 1].$$

There is an oracle algorithm $\mathcal{E}$ such that $\mathcal{E}^\mathcal{A}(\mathbf{u}_0, y_0)$, on input $\mathbf{u}_0 \leftarrow \mathcal{U}$, $y_0 \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\mathbf{u}_0)$, with probability at least

$$\epsilon_\Psi(\mathcal{A}) - \ell/|\mathcal{S}|, \quad (7)$$

outputs $\ell + 1$ pairs $(\mathbf{u}_i, y_i)_{i=0}^\ell$ such that $\Psi(\mathbf{u}_i, y_i) = 1$ for all $i \in [0, \ell]$, and $\mathbf{u}_i \equiv_i \mathbf{u}_0$ for all $i \in [\ell]$. $\mathcal{E}$ calls $\mathcal{A}$ for $1 + \ell$ times in expectation.

2.2 Lattice-based Binding Commitments

We recall binding commitment schemes and instantiate them with the module-variant of the Ajtai hash function [Ajt96; PR06; LM06].

Definition 2.1. A binding commitment $\text{CM} = (\text{Setup}, \text{Commit}, \text{RVfyOpen})$ with message space $\mathcal{M}^*$, commitment space $\mathbb{C}$ and opening space $\mathcal{O}$ consists of algorithms:

- $\text{Setup}(1^\lambda) \rightarrow \text{pp}_{\text{cm}}$: on input security parameter 1^λ , output parameter pp_{cm} .
- $\text{Commit}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, m) \rightarrow (c, o)$: on input parameter pp_{cm} and a message $m \in \mathcal{M}^*$, output a commitment $c \in \mathbb{C}$ and an opening state $o \in \mathcal{O}$.
- $\text{RVfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, m, o) \rightarrow b$: on input the parameter pp_{cm} , commitment $c \in \mathbb{C}$, message $m \in \mathcal{M}^*$, opening $o \in \mathcal{O}$, output a bit b indicating whether (m, o) is an opening of c w.r.t. pp_{cm} .

CM satisfies the following properties:

Perfect Completeness: For all λ and $m \in \mathcal{M}^*$,

$$\Pr \left[\begin{array}{l} \text{pp}_{\text{cm}} \leftarrow \text{Setup}(1^\lambda), \\ (c, o) \leftarrow \text{Commit}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, m) \end{array} : \text{RVfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, m, o) = 1 \right] = 1.$$

Binding: For all expected poly-time adversary $\mathcal{A}$,

$$\Pr \left[\begin{array}{l} \text{pp}_{\text{cm}} \leftarrow \text{Setup}(1^\lambda), \\ \left(c, \begin{pmatrix} m_1, o_1 \\ m_2, o_2 \end{pmatrix} \right) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}) \end{array} : \begin{array}{l} m_1 \neq m_2 \wedge \forall i \in [2] : \\ \text{RVfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, m_i, o_i) = 1 \end{array} \right] \leq \text{negl}(\lambda).$$

We instantiate the binding commitment below. Notably, we add a *strict* opening verification interface $\text{VfyOpen}(\cdot)$ to distinguish *strict* and *relaxed* openings, where the former has a more restricted opening space. In our folding scheme, an honest prover always follows the strict opening procedure, relaxed openings are only used in knowledge soundness proofs.

Construction 2.1. Fix set $\mathcal{S} \subseteq R_q$, a bound $B_{\text{bnd}} \in \mathbb{R}$ to be specified later and let $B_{\text{rbnd}} := 2B_{\text{bnd}}$. Set commitment space $\mathbb{C} := R_q^\kappa$ where $\kappa = \kappa(\lambda)$, (relaxed) opening space $\mathcal{O} := \mathcal{O}'_{B_{\text{rbnd}}} \times (\mathcal{S} - \mathcal{S})$ where

$$\mathcal{O}'_{B_{\text{rbnd}}} := \{\mathbf{f} \in R_q^n : \|\mathbf{v}\|_2 \leq B_{\text{rbnd}}\} \quad (8)$$

and let the message space be

$$\mathcal{M}^* := \{\mathbf{m} \in R_q^n : \exists(\mathbf{f}, s) \in \mathcal{O} : s \cdot \mathbf{m} = \mathbf{f}\}. \quad (9)$$

The commitment $\text{CM} = (\text{Setup}, \text{Commit}, \text{RVfyOpen}, \text{VfyOpen})$ works as follows:

- $\text{Setup}(1^\lambda) \rightarrow \text{pp}_{\text{cm}} : \text{Output } \text{pp}_{\text{cm}} := \mathbf{A} \leftarrow_{\$} R_q^{\kappa \times n}$.
- $\text{Commit}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, \mathbf{m} = \mathbf{f}/s \in \mathcal{M}^*) \rightarrow c : \text{Output } c := \mathbf{A}\mathbf{m} \text{ and } o := (\mathbf{f}, s)$.
- $\text{RVfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{m}, o = (\mathbf{f}, s)) \rightarrow b : \text{Output } 1 \text{ if and only if}$

$$\mathbf{A}\mathbf{f} = s \cdot c \wedge o \in \mathcal{O} \wedge s \cdot \mathbf{m} = \mathbf{f}. \quad (10)$$

- $\text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{m}, o = (\mathbf{f}, s)) \rightarrow b : \text{Output } 1 \text{ if and only if } s = 1 \text{ and}$

$$\mathbf{A}\mathbf{f} = c \wedge \|\mathbf{f}\|_2 < B_{\text{bnd}} \wedge \mathbf{m} = \mathbf{f}. \quad (11)$$

We simply write $\text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1$ in this case.

We focus on the binding property as completeness is straightforward. Let T be the operator norm of $\mathcal{S}$. As noted in [BS23], the (relaxed) binding property follows from the Module-SIS assumption $\text{MSIS}_{q, \kappa, n, 4TB_{\text{rbnd}}}$ defined below.

Definition 2.2 (Module SIS [LS15]). *Let $q = q(\lambda)$, $\kappa = \kappa(\lambda)$, $n = n(\lambda)$ and $\beta_{\text{SIS}} = \beta_{\text{SIS}}(\lambda)$. The $\text{MSIS}_{q, \kappa, n, \beta_{\text{SIS}}}$ assumption states that for all expected polynomial-time adversary $\mathcal{A}$,*

$$\Pr \left[\begin{array}{l} \mathbf{A} \leftarrow_{\$} R_q^{\kappa \times n} \\ \mathbf{x} \in R_q^n \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\mathbf{A}) \end{array} : (\mathbf{A}\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{0}) \wedge (0 < \|\mathbf{x}\|_2 \leq \beta_{\text{SIS}}) \right] < \text{negl}(\lambda).$$

Fine-grained commitment opening relation. Sometimes we need a more fine-grained check on opening vectors. Set $\ell_h \in \mathbb{N}$ and $B \in \mathbb{R}$, with $\ell_h \mid n$. We say that $\text{VfyOpen}_{\ell_h, B}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1$ if

$$\mathbf{A}\mathbf{f} = c \wedge \forall (i, j) \in [n/\ell_h] \times [d] : \|\mathbf{F}_{i,j}\|_2 \leq B. \quad (12)$$

Here $\mathbf{F}_{i,j} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{\ell_h \times 1}$ is the submatrix of $\text{cf}(\mathbf{f}) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n \times d}$. That is,

$$\text{cf}(\mathbf{f}) = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{F}_{1,1} & \cdots & \mathbf{F}_{1,d} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \mathbf{F}_{n/\ell_h,1} & \cdots & \mathbf{F}_{n/\ell_h,d} \end{bmatrix}.$$

If $B \cdot \sqrt{nd/\ell_h} \leq B_{\text{bnd}}$, we have $\text{VfyOpen}_{\ell_h, B}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1 \implies \text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1$.

2.3 Tensor of Rings

We describe the **Tensor-of-Rings** framework inspired by [BC25; DP24; NS25]. Given an extension field $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{F}_{q^t}$ and a ring $R_q = \mathbb{Z}_q[X]/\langle X^d + 1 \rangle$, define the tensor

$$\mathbb{E} := \mathbb{K} \otimes_{\mathbb{F}_q} R_q. \quad (13)$$

An element e in $\mathbb{E}$ can be represented as a matrix over $\mathbb{Z}_q^{t \times d}$, and $\mathbb{E}$ supports two types of algebraic operations:

- By viewing each column of e as a $\mathbb{K}$ -element, $e = [e_1, \dots, e_d] \in \mathbb{K}^{1 \times d}$ is an element in the vector space $\mathbb{K}^d$. Thus we can perform scalar multiplication between $a \in \mathbb{K}$ and $e \in \mathbb{E}$, that is, $a \cdot [e_1, \dots, e_d] = [a \cdot e_1, \dots, a \cdot e_d]$.
- By viewing each row of $\mathbb{E}$ as an R_q -element, $e = (e'_1, \dots, e'_t) \in R_q^t$ is an element in the R_q -module⁴ of dimension t . Thus we can perform scalar multiplication between $e \in \mathbb{E}$ and $b \in R_q$, that is, $(e'_1, \dots, e'_t) \cdot b = (b \cdot e'_1, \dots, b \cdot e'_t)$.

Looking ahead, the $\mathbb{K}$ -vector space interpretation enables running sumcheck protocols over $\mathbb{K}$; the R_q -module interpretation enables folding witnesses via low-norm challenges over $\mathcal{S} \subseteq R_q$.

Multiplication between R_q and $\mathbb{K}$. Given the tensor $\mathbb{E}$, we define “multiplications” between an R_q -element and a $\mathbb{K}$ -element: Take $a \in \mathbb{K}$ with coefficient vector $\text{cf}(a) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^d$ and $b \in R_q$ with coefficient vector $\text{cf}(b) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^d$, we define $a \cdot b \in \mathbb{E}$ as the $\mathbb{E}$ -element represented by the matrix

$$\text{cf}(a) \otimes \text{cf}(b)^\top \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{t \times d}.$$

There are two ways to interpret this multiplication:

- lift $b \in R_q$ to $e_b := \begin{bmatrix} b \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{E}$ (where the 1st row is b , followed by $t - 1$ zero rows) and perform scalar multiplication between $a \in \mathbb{K}$ and e_b (by viewing e_b as in $\mathbb{K}^{1 \times d}$).
- lift $a \in \mathbb{K}$ to $e_a := [a, 0, \dots, 0] \in \mathbb{E}$ (where the 1st column is a , followed by $d - 1$ zero columns) and perform scalar multiplication between e_a and $b \in R_q$ (by viewing e_a as in R_q^t).

2.4 Generalized Reduction of Knowledge

We provide a generalized definition of reduction of knowledge (RoK) [KP23] that allows for both *imperfect* completeness and *relaxed* knowledge soundness. That is, an honest prover may fail with negligible probability, and extracted witnesses have a less stringent validity requirement. This definition remains useful for applications involving a small number of recursive folding steps.

⁴Modules are generalizations of vector spaces where scalars are ring elements.

Definition 2.3 (Generalized Reduction of Knowledge). *Let $\mathcal{R}_1, \mathcal{R}'_1, \mathcal{R}_2$ be indexed relations. A reduction of knowledge Π from $\mathcal{R}_1$ to $\mathcal{R}_2$ (with relaxed input relation $\mathcal{R}'_1$) consists of PPT algorithms below:*

- $\mathcal{G}(1^\lambda) \rightarrow \mathfrak{i}$: on input security parameter λ output index $\mathfrak{i}$.
- $\mathsf{P}(\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1, \mathfrak{w}_1) \rightarrow (\mathfrak{x}_2, \mathfrak{w}_2)$: take index $\mathfrak{i}$, a statement $(\mathfrak{x}_1, \mathfrak{w}_1)$ such that $(\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1, \mathfrak{w}_1) \in \mathcal{R}_1$, interact with the verifier, and output a statement $(\mathfrak{x}_2, \mathfrak{w}_2)$ such that $(\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_2, \mathfrak{w}_2) \in \mathcal{R}_2$.
- $\mathsf{V}(\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1) \rightarrow \mathfrak{x}_2$: take index $\mathfrak{i}$, an instance $\mathfrak{x}_1$ for $\mathcal{R}_1$, interacts with the prover, and output an instance $\mathfrak{x}_2$ for relation $\mathcal{R}_2$. V outputs $\perp$ if rejects early.

We denote by $\langle \mathsf{P}(\mathfrak{w}_1), \mathsf{V} \rangle [\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1] \rightarrow (\mathfrak{x}_2, \mathfrak{w}_2)$ the interaction between P and V with common input $(\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1)$. By default, (i) the reduced instances output by P and V are the same, and (ii) $\perp \notin \mathcal{L}(\mathcal{R}_2)$. For notational convenience, we omit index $\mathfrak{i}$ when clear in context.

The reduction of knowledge satisfies the properties below.

Definition 2.4 (ϵ -Completeness). *For all PPT adversary $\mathcal{A}$,*

$$\Pr \left[\begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{i} \leftarrow \mathcal{G}(1^\lambda) \\ (\mathfrak{x}_1, \mathfrak{w}_1) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\mathfrak{i}) \\ (\mathfrak{x}_2, \mathfrak{w}_2) \leftarrow \langle \mathsf{P}(\mathfrak{w}_1), \mathsf{V} \rangle [\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1] \end{array} : \begin{array}{l} (\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1, \mathfrak{w}_1) \in \mathcal{R}_1 \wedge \\ (\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_2, \mathfrak{w}_2) \notin \mathcal{R}_2 \end{array} \right] \leq \epsilon.$$

Definition 2.5 (κ -Knowledge Soundness w.r.t. $\mathcal{R}'_1$). *There exists a function $\kappa(\cdot)$ such that for all expected polynomial time adversaries P^* with non-negligible success probability, there is an expected polynomial time extractor Ext , given $\mathfrak{i} \leftarrow \mathcal{G}(1^\lambda)$, $(\mathfrak{x}_1, \mathsf{st}) \leftarrow \mathsf{P}^*(\mathfrak{i})$,*

$$\left| \Pr [(\mathfrak{i}, \langle \mathsf{P}^*(\mathsf{st}), \mathsf{V} \rangle [\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1]) \in \mathcal{R}_2] - \Pr [(\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1, \mathsf{Ext}^{\mathsf{P}^*}(\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1, \mathsf{st})) \in \mathcal{R}'_1] \right| \leq \kappa(\lambda).$$

When $\mathcal{R}'_1 = \mathcal{R}_1$, we simply say that it satisfies κ -knowledge soundness.

Definition 2.6 (Public reducibility). *There is a deterministic polynomial time algorithm f such that for all PPT adversary $\mathcal{A}$ and expected polynomial time adversary P^* :*

$$\Pr \left[\begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{i} \leftarrow \mathcal{G}(1^\lambda) \\ (\mathfrak{x}_1, \mathsf{st}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\mathfrak{i}) \\ (\mathsf{tr}, \mathfrak{x}_2, \mathfrak{w}_2) \leftarrow \langle \mathsf{P}^*(\mathsf{st}), \mathsf{V} \rangle [\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1] \end{array} : f(\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1, \mathsf{tr}) = \mathfrak{x}_2 \right] = 1.$$

Here tr denotes the transcript of the interaction $\langle \mathsf{P}^*(\mathsf{st}), \mathsf{V} \rangle [\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}_1]$.

2.5 The Sumcheck Protocol

Let $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{F}_{q^t}$ be an extension field. For vector $\mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^k$, we define its tensor $\mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r})$ as

$$\mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}) := (eq_b(\mathbf{r}))_{b \in \{0,1\}^k} \in \mathbb{K}^{2^k} \quad (14)$$

where $eq_b(\mathbf{r}) := \prod_{i \in [k]} [(1 - b_i)(1 - \mathbf{r}_i) + b_i \mathbf{r}_i]$. For a multilinear polynomial⁵ $f(\mathbf{X}) \in \mathbb{K}^{\leq 1}[X_1, \dots, X_{\log(n)}]$, we denote by its evaluation vector $\mathbf{f}$ as

$$\mathbf{f} := (f(b))_{b \in \{0,1\}^{\log(n)}} \in \mathbb{K}^n.$$

Observe that the evaluation $f(\mathbf{r})$ at point $\mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log(n)}$ satisfies that

$$f(\mathbf{r}) := \sum_{b \in \{0,1\}^{\log(n)}} f(b) \cdot eq_b(\mathbf{r}) = \langle \mathbf{f}, \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle.$$

Let $g(\mathbf{X}) \in \mathbb{K}^{\leq D}[X_1, \dots, X_{\log(n)}]$ denote a multivariate polynomial over $\mathbb{K}$ of individual degree at most D . We use $c = \text{Commit}(g)$ to denote that c is a “virtual commitment” to the polynomial g . The classical sumcheck protocol [LFKN92] can be understood as a special reduction of knowledge from

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{sum}} := \left\{ (\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{x} = (c, v \in \mathbb{K}), \\ \mathfrak{w} = g(\mathbf{X}) \quad \text{s.t.} \\ c = \text{Commit}(g) \wedge \sum_{b \in \{0,1\}^{\log(n)}} g(b) = v \end{array} \right\}. \quad (15)$$

to the relation

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{eval}} := \left\{ (\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{x} = (c, \mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log(n)}, v \in \mathbb{K}), \\ \mathfrak{w} = g(\mathbf{X}) \quad \text{s.t.} \\ c = \text{Commit}(g) \wedge g(\mathbf{r}) = v \end{array} \right\}. \quad (16)$$

The protocol has linear-time prover and polylogarithmic verifier. The knowledge error is $\epsilon_{\text{sum}} := D \log(n)/|\mathbb{K}| + \epsilon_{\text{bind}}$ where ϵ_{bind} is the binding error of the commitment.

When $g(\mathbf{X})$ is of the special form $g(\mathbf{X}) = h(f_1(\mathbf{X}), \dots, f_k(\mathbf{X}))$ for some polynomial h and *multilinear* polynomials $f_1, \dots, f_k$, we instantiate the commitment c as the commitments to the evaluation vectors $(\mathbf{f}_i)_{i=1}^k$, and the claim $g(\mathbf{r}) = v$ is equivalent to

$$(\forall i \in [k] : \langle \mathbf{f}_i, \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = u_i) \wedge h(u_1, \dots, u_k) = v. \quad (17)$$

for some $u_1, \dots, u_k \in \mathbb{K}$. By letting the verifier check $h(u_1, \dots, u_k) = v$, $\mathcal{R}_{\text{eval}}$ can be simplified to a linear relation

$$\mathcal{R}'_{\text{eval}} := \left\{ (\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{x} = ((c_i)_{i=1}^k, \mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log(n)}, (u_i \in \mathbb{K})_{i=1}^k), \\ \mathfrak{w} = (\mathbf{f}_i)_{i=1}^k \quad \text{s.t.} \\ \forall i \in [k] : \langle \mathbf{f}_i, \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = u_i \wedge c_i = \text{Commit}(\mathbf{f}_i) \end{array} \right\}. \quad (18)$$

Sumcheck batching. Given k sumcheck claims over $\mathbb{K}$ w.r.t. polynomials $g_1, \dots, g_k \in \mathbb{K}^{\leq D}[X_1, \dots, X_{\log(n)}]$, we can reduce them to a single sumcheck claim for $\sum_{i=1}^k g_i \cdot \alpha^{i-1} \in \mathbb{K}^{\leq D}[X_1, \dots, X_{\log(n)}]$, where $\alpha \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{K}$ is a challenge sampled by the verifier.

⁵A multilinear polynomial is a multivariate polynomial with individual degree ≤ 1 .

2.6 (Commit-and-Prove) SNARKs

We review and generalize the notion of SNARKs and commit-and-prove SNARKs.

Definition 2.7 (SNARKs). *Let $\text{GenR}(1^\lambda) \rightarrow (\mathcal{R}, \mathcal{R}', \mathfrak{i})$ be an algorithm that outputs the description of a relation $\mathcal{R}$, a relaxed relation $\mathcal{R}'$, and an index $\mathfrak{i}$ on input the security parameter. We simply write $\text{GenR}(1^\lambda) \rightarrow (\mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{i})$ when $\mathcal{R} = \mathcal{R}'$. A succinct non-interactive argument of knowledge (SNARK) Π w.r.t. GenR consists of algorithms:*

$\text{Setup}(\mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{i}) \rightarrow (\text{pk}, \text{vk})$: take relation description $\mathcal{R}$ and index $\mathfrak{i}$, output proving parameter pk and verifier parameter vk . We omit input $\mathfrak{i}$ when clear in context.

$\text{Prove}(\text{pk}, \mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) \rightarrow \pi$: take proving parameter pk , relation $\mathcal{R}$, instance-witness pair $(\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w})$, output a proof π .

$\text{Vf}(\text{vk}, \mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{x}, \pi) \rightarrow b$: take verifier parameter vk , relation $\mathcal{R}$, instance $\mathfrak{x}$, and proof π , output a bit b indicating accept ($b = 1$) or reject.

A SNARK satisfies properties below:

Completeness: *For all PPT adversary $\mathcal{A}$,*

$$\Pr \left[\begin{array}{l} (\mathcal{R}, \mathcal{R}', \mathfrak{i}) \leftarrow \text{GenR}(1^\lambda), (\text{pk}, \text{vk}) \leftarrow \text{Setup}(\mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{i}) \\ (\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{i}), \pi \leftarrow \text{Prove}(\text{pk}, \mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) \end{array} : \begin{array}{l} (\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) \in \mathcal{R} \wedge \\ \text{Vf}(\text{vk}, \mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{x}, \pi) = 0 \end{array} \right] \leq \text{negl}(\lambda).$$

Succinctness: *The bitlength of proof π is $\text{poly}(\lambda, \log(|\mathfrak{w}|))$ and the verifier time is $\text{poly}(\lambda, |\mathfrak{x}|, \log(|\mathfrak{w}|))$.*

Knowledge soundness w.r.t. $\mathcal{R}'$: *For all PPT adversary $\mathcal{P}^*$, there exists an expected PPT extractor Ext such that*

$$\Pr \left[\begin{array}{l} (\mathcal{R}, \mathcal{R}', \mathfrak{i}) \leftarrow \text{GenR}(1^\lambda), (\text{pk}, \text{vk}) \leftarrow \text{Setup}(\mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{i}) \\ (\mathfrak{x}, \pi) \leftarrow \mathcal{P}^*(\text{pk}, \mathcal{R}), \mathfrak{w} \leftarrow \text{Ext}(\text{pk}, \text{vk}, \mathcal{R}, \mathcal{R}', \mathfrak{i}) \end{array} : \begin{array}{l} (\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) \notin \mathcal{R}' \wedge \\ \text{Vf}(\text{vk}, \mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{x}, \pi) = 1 \end{array} \right] \leq \text{negl}(\lambda).$$

Next, we recall commit-and-prove SNARKs (CP-SNARKs) [Kil89; CLOS02; CFQ19]. Informally, given an instance $\mathfrak{x}$ and a commitment c , it proves knowledge of $\mathfrak{w} := (\mathfrak{w}_1, \mathfrak{w}_2)$ such that $(\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) \in \mathcal{R}$ and $\mathfrak{w}_1$ is an opening to the commitment c . For PolyIOP-based SNARKs [Chi+20; BFS20] that rely on polynomial commitments [KZG10], their CP-SNARK versions have similar efficiency as standard SNARKs.

Definition 2.8 (CP-SNARKs [Kil89; CLOS02; CFQ19]). *Let $\text{GenR}(1^\lambda) \rightarrow (\mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{i})$ be a relation generator as in Definition 2.7 where the witness space is $\mathcal{M}_1^* \times \dots \times \mathcal{M}_\ell^* \times \mathcal{M}_0^*$. Let $\text{CM} = (\text{Setup}, \text{Commit}, \text{RVfyOpen})$ be a commitment scheme. Define relation generator $\text{GenR}_c(1^\lambda)$:*

- *Run $(\mathcal{R}, \mathfrak{i}) \leftarrow \text{GenR}(1^\lambda)$ and $\text{pp}_{\text{cm}} \leftarrow \text{Setup}(1^\lambda)$.*

- Output $\mathfrak{i}' := (\mathbf{pp}_{\text{cm}}, \mathfrak{i})$ and relation

$$\mathcal{R}' := \left\{ \begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{i}' = (\mathbf{pp}_{\text{cm}}, \mathfrak{i}), \\ \mathfrak{x}' := (\mathfrak{x}, (c_i)_{i=1}^\ell), \\ \mathfrak{w}' := ((w_i, o_i)_{i=1}^\ell, w^*) \end{array} : \begin{array}{l} (\mathfrak{i}, \mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w} = (w_1, \dots, w_\ell, w^*)) \in \mathcal{R} \wedge \\ \forall i \in [\ell] : \text{CM.RVfyOpen}(\mathbf{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c_i, w_i, o_i) = 1 \end{array} \right\}. \quad (19)$$

A Commit-and-Prove SNARK (CP-SNARK) for CM and GenR is a SNARK w.r.t. GenR_c .

3 A Toolbox of Reduction of Knowledge

In this section, we introduce several reductions of knowledge that will serve as building blocks for our folding schemes.

Relation parameters. All relations in this paper share the public parameters:

$$\mathfrak{i} := (\mathbf{pp}_{\text{cm}}, R_q, \mathbb{K}, \mathbb{E}) \quad (20)$$

where $R_q := \mathbb{Z}_q[X]/\langle X^d + 1 \rangle$ for a prime q and a power-of-two d , and $\mathbf{pp}_{\text{cm}} = \mathbf{A} \in R_q^{\kappa \times n}$ is the MSIS matrix for the lattice commitment CM (with commitment space $\mathbb{C} := R_q^\kappa$), $\mathbb{K} := \mathbb{F}_{q^t}$, and $\mathbb{E} := R_q \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}_q} \mathbb{K}$ is the tensor ring. In the following, we omit index $\mathfrak{i}$ in relations for simplicity.

3.1 Generic Committed Linear Relation

We introduce **generic committed linear relations**, which serve as the anchor between our folding scheme and a SNARK. Looking forward, the folding scheme reduces multiple statements, including the R1CS and range statements for the committed witnesses, into two efficiently provable claims in this linear relation.

The relation is parameterized by

$$\text{aux} := (n_{\text{in}} \in \mathbb{N}, (\mathbf{M}_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m_i \times n})_{i=1}^{k_x}), M := \max_{i \in [k_x]} \{m_i\}$$

where n_{in} is the public input length, the matrices $(\mathbf{M}_i)_{i \in [k_x]}$ is a set of linear transformations to the witness, $(m_i)_{i=1}^{k_x}$ are powers of two and $n \geq n_{\text{in}}$ is the witness length. The generic committed linear relation is defined as

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}} := \left\{ (\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{x} = (c \in \mathbb{C}, \mathbf{x} \in R_q^{n_{\text{in}}}, \mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log M}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{E}^{k_x}) \\ \mathfrak{w} = \mathbf{f} \in R_q^n \text{ s.t.} \\ \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}[1..n_{\text{in}}] \quad \wedge \quad \text{VfyOpen}(\mathbf{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1 \\ \wedge \forall i \in [k_x] : \langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r})[1..m_i], \mathbf{M}_i \mathbf{f} \rangle = \mathbf{v}_i \end{array} \right\}. \quad (21)$$

In words, the witness $\mathbf{f}$ is a valid opening to the commitment c and matches the public input $\mathbf{x}$; moreover, for $i \in [k_x]$, $\mathbf{v}_i$ equals the inner product between $\mathbf{M}_i \mathbf{f}$ and $\mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r})$'s prefix, where the tensor vector $\mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \in \mathbb{K}^M$ is defined in Eq. (14).

3.2 RoKs for Hadamard Relations

We reduce checking a batched Hadamard product relation (common in R1CS) to a generic linear relation. The idea is similar to that in Neo [NS25] and LatticeFold+ [BC25]. Fix parameter $\text{aux} := (n_{\text{in}} = 0, (\mathbf{M}_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m \times n})_{i=1}^3)$ where m is a power-of-two. The input relation is

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{had}}^{\text{aux}} := \left\{ (\mathbb{x}, \mathbb{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathbb{x} = c \in \mathbb{C}, \quad \mathbb{w} = \mathbf{F} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n \times d} \quad \text{s.t.} \\ (\mathbf{M}_1 \mathbf{F}) \circ (\mathbf{M}_2 \mathbf{F}) = \mathbf{M}_3 \mathbf{F} \quad \wedge \quad \text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{F})) = 1 \end{array} \right\}, \quad (22)$$

where $\circ$ denotes element-wise multiplication. The output relation is⁶

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}} := \left\{ (\mathbb{x}, \mathbb{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathbb{x} = (c \in \mathbb{C}, \mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log m}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{E}^3), \\ \mathbb{w} = \mathbf{f} \in R_q^n \quad \text{s.t.} \\ \text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1 \quad \wedge \quad \forall i \in [3] : \langle (\mathbf{M}_i \mathbf{f}), \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = \mathbf{v}_i \end{array} \right\}. \quad (23)$$

The reduction protocol Π_{had} is described in Figure 1. It first translates the Hadamard product relation into a sumcheck claim via *structural* random linear combinations, and then runs a sumcheck protocol to reduce the claim into linear evaluation statements over $\mathbb{K}$. Finally, the verifier packs evaluation values into $\mathbb{E}$ -elements to match the committed witness.

Proposition 3.1. Π_{had} in Figure 1 is an RoK from $\mathcal{R}_{\text{had}}^{\text{aux}}$ (Eq. (22)) to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$ (Eq. (23)).

Proof. We show that Π_{had} is perfectly complete and $((d + \log(m))/|\mathbb{K}| + \epsilon_{\text{sum}})$ -knowledge sound, where ϵ_{sum} is the knowledge error of the *committed* sumcheck RoK in Section 2.5.

Completeness. If the input $(\mathbb{x} = c, \mathbb{w} = \mathbf{F}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{had}}^{\text{aux}}$, the sumcheck claim in Eq. (24) holds. By the completeness of the sumcheck RoK, the verifier's check in Eq. (25) passes, and the output is in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$.

Knowledge soundness. Consider an adversary P^* . The extractor simulates the protocol with P^* , and from P^* 's output $w_o = \mathbf{f}$, it returns $\mathbf{F} := \text{cf}(\mathbf{f})$.

Suppose $(\mathbb{x}_o, w_o) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$, i.e., $\text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{F})$ is a valid opening to c and the linear evaluation statements hold. If $\mathbf{F}$ does not satisfy the Hadamard product check in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{had}}^{\text{aux}}$, then exists a column $j \in [d]$ where the Hadamard check fails for $\mathbf{F}_{*,j}$. Thus, with probability at least $1 - (\log(n)/|\mathbb{K}|)$ (over random $\mathbf{s}$),

$$\sum_{b \in \{0,1\}^{\log(m)}} f_j(b) \neq 0.$$

Conditioned on this, with probability at least $1 - (d/|\mathbb{K}|)$ (over random α), the sumcheck claim in Eq. (24) is false. By the soundness of the *committed* sumcheck RoK, the knowledge error is bounded by $\epsilon_{\text{sum}} + (d + \log(n))/|\mathbb{K}|$. $\square$

Proposition 3.2. Π_{had} in Figure 1 runs a single degree-3 sumcheck protocol over $\mathbb{K}$ of size m . The additional complexity beyond the sumcheck is as follows:

⁶When computing $\mathbf{M}_i \mathbf{f} \in R_q^m$, $\mathbf{M}_i$'s entries are interpreted as R_q -elements.

Parameters: $\text{aux} := (n_{\text{in}} = 0, (\mathbf{M}_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m \times n})_{i=1}^3)$

Input: $\mathbb{x} = c \in \mathbb{C}$ and $\mathbb{w} = \mathbf{F} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n \times d}$

Output: $\mathbb{x}_o = (c, \mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log m}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{E}^3)$ and $\mathbb{w}_o = \mathbf{f} \in R_q^n$

The protocol $\langle \mathbf{P}(\mathbb{x}; \mathbb{w}); \mathbf{V}(\mathbb{x}) \rangle$:

1. $\mathbf{V} \rightarrow \mathbf{P}$: Send challenges $\mathbf{s} \leftarrow \mathbb{K}^{\log m}$ and $\alpha \leftarrow \mathbb{K}$
2. $\mathbf{P} \leftrightarrow \mathbf{V}$: Run a sumcheck protocol for the claim

$$\sum_{b \in \{0,1\}^{\log m}} \left(\sum_{j=1}^d \alpha^{j-1} \cdot f_j(b) \right) = 0 \quad (24)$$

where the polynomial $f_j(\mathbf{X}) \in \mathbb{K}[X_1, \dots, X_{\log m}]$ ($1 \leq j \leq d$) is defined as

$$f_j(\mathbf{X}) = eq(\mathbf{s}, \mathbf{X}) \cdot (g_{1,j}(\mathbf{X}) \cdot g_{2,j}(\mathbf{X}) - g_{3,j}(\mathbf{X}))$$

and $g_{i,j}(\mathbf{X})$ ($1 \leq i \leq 3$) is the multilinear extension of $\mathbf{M}_i \mathbf{F}_{*,j} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^m$.

The protocol reduces to an evaluation claim

$$\sum_{j=1}^d \alpha^{j-1} \cdot f_j(\mathbf{r}) = e$$

where $\mathbf{r} \leftarrow \mathbb{K}^{\log m}$ is the sumcheck challenge and $e \in \mathbb{K}$

3. $\mathbf{P} \rightarrow \mathbf{V}$: Send values $\mathbf{U} \in \mathbb{K}^{3 \times d}$ where $\mathbf{U}_{i,j} := g_{i,j}(\mathbf{r})$ for $i \in [3]$ and $j \in [d]$
4. $\mathbf{V}$: Compute $eq(\mathbf{s}, \mathbf{r}) \in \mathbb{K}$ and check

$$\sum_{j=1}^d \alpha^{j-1} \cdot eq(\mathbf{s}, \mathbf{r}) \cdot (\mathbf{U}_{1,j} \cdot \mathbf{U}_{2,j} - \mathbf{U}_{3,j}) \stackrel{?}{=} e. \quad (25)$$

Abort if it fails, otherwise output $\mathbb{x}_o := (c, \mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{E}^3)$ where ^a for $i \in [3]$

$$\mathbf{v}_i := \sum_{j=1}^d (X^{j-1}) \cdot \mathbf{U}_{i,j} \in \mathbb{E}.$$

5. $\mathbf{P}$: output $\mathbb{w}_o := \text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{F})$

^aHere $X^{j-1} \in \mathcal{M} \subseteq R_q$ for $j \in [d]$. The multiplication between R_q and $\mathbb{K}$ is defined in [Section 2.3](#).

Figure 1: The protocol Π_{had} to reduce $\mathcal{R}_{\text{had}}^{\text{aux}}$ to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$.

- **Prover cost** $T_p^{\text{had}}(m)$: $3d$ inner products between $\mathbb{Z}_q^m \subseteq \mathbb{K}^m$ and $\mathbb{K}^m$ (for computing $\mathbf{U}$), and the cost for computing⁷ $(\mathbf{M}_i \mathbf{F})_{i=1}^3$.
- **Verifier cost** $T_v^{\text{had}}(m)$: $O(d + \log(m))$ $\mathbb{K}$ -ops.
- **Verifier randomness** $\Gamma_v^{\text{had}}(m)$: $O(\log(m))$ $\mathbb{K}$ -elements.

3.3 RoKs for Monomial Relations

LatticeFold+[BC25] introduces an RoK for monomials. The monomial statement checks that each commitment opening is a monomial vector, i.e., each entry lies in the monomial set $\mathcal{M} := \{0, 1, X, \dots, X^{d-1}\} \subseteq R_q$ (Eq. (2)). The RoK then reduces this claim to a linear statement. It is also a building block for the range proof in Section 3.4.

Lemma 3.1 (Lemma 4.2 of [BC25]). *For parameters $k_g, n \in \mathbb{N}$ where n is a power-of-two, there exists a reduction of knowledge Π_{mon} from relation*

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{mon}, k_g} := \left\{ (\mathbf{z}, \mathbf{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathbf{z} = (c^{(i)} \in \mathbb{C})_{i=1}^{k_g}, \quad \mathbf{w} = (\mathbf{g}^{(i)} \in R_q^n)_{i=1}^{k_g} \quad \text{s.t.} \\ \forall i \in [k_g] : \text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c^{(i)}, \mathbf{g}^{(i)}) = 1 \wedge \mathbf{g}^{(i)} \in \mathcal{M}^n \end{array} \right\}, \quad (26)$$

to relation

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g} := \left\{ (\mathbf{z}, \mathbf{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathbf{z} = (\mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log n}, [c^{(i)} \in \mathbb{C}, \mathbf{u}^{(i)} \in \mathbb{F}_{i=1}^{k_g}], \\ \mathbf{w} = (\mathbf{g}^{(i)} \in R_q^n)_{i=1}^{k_g} \quad \text{s.t.} \\ \forall i \in [k_g] : \text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c^{(i)}, \mathbf{g}^{(i)}) = 1 \wedge \langle \mathbf{g}^{(i)}, \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = \mathbf{u}^{(i)} \end{array} \right\}. \quad (27)$$

Here the multiplication between $\mathbf{g}^{(i)}$ (over R_q) and $\text{ts}(\mathbf{r})$ (over $\mathbb{K}$) is defined in Section 2.3.

Besides a single degree-3 sumcheck over $\mathbb{K}$ of size n , the prover's complexity $T_p^{\text{mon}}(k_g, n)$ is $O(nk_g)$ $\mathbb{K}$ -additions (for computing $(\mathbf{u}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$) and $O(n)$ $\mathbb{K}$ -ops. The verifier's complexity $T_v^{\text{mon}}(k_g, n)$ is $O(k_g d + \log(n))$ $\mathbb{K}$ -ops.

We present an RoK protocol in Appendix A, which simplifies and generalizes the construction from [BC25]. We refer to [BC25] for a detailed security proof.

3.4 Approximate Range Proofs for Ring Vectors

We show a reduction of knowledge from the norm-check of ring vectors to generic linear statements. The protocol is inspired by the exact-norm proof from [BC25] and the random projection techniques from [BS23; KLN025]. Combined with the folding protocol in Section 4, this primitive helps efficiently reduce multiple norm-check statements into a *single* linear statement.

As a tradeoff, the protocol provides only an approximate range proof, i.e., the extracted witness may have a slightly larger norm than specified in the completeness relation. This is sufficient when the folding depth is a small constant (e.g., 1 or 2).

⁷It takes $O((m+n)d)$ $\mathbb{Z}_q$ -multiplications when $\mathbf{M}_i$'s are sparse RICS matrices.

Let $n \in \mathbb{N}$ denote the witness length, and $\ell_h \in \mathbb{N}$, $\lambda_{\text{pj}} := 256$ denote the projection input and output length, with $\ell_h \mid n$. Set norm bound $B \in \mathbb{R}$ and $d' := d - 2$. Let k_g be the minimal integer such that

$$B_{d,k_g} := (d'/2) \cdot (1 + d' + \dots + d'^{k_g-1}) \geq 9.5B. \quad (28)$$

Define input relation

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{rg}}^{\ell_h, B} := \left\{ (\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{x} = c \in \mathbb{C} \quad \mathfrak{w} = \mathbf{f} \in R_q^n \quad \text{s.t.} \\ \text{VfyOpen}_{\ell_h, B}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1 \text{ (Eq. (12))} \end{array} \right\}. \quad (29)$$

Denote by $\text{aux}_J := (n_{\text{in}} = 0, \mathbf{M}_J := \mathbf{I}_{n/\ell_h} \otimes \mathbf{J} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{(n\lambda_{\text{pj}}/\ell_h) \times n})$ for some random $\mathbf{J} \leftarrow \chi^{\lambda_{\text{pj}} \times \ell_h}$. For simplicity, assume that $m := n\lambda_{\text{pj}}/\ell_h$ is a power of two and $md = n$. (The scheme naturally extends to more general parameter choices.) The output relation is $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}_J} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ where $\mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ is defined in Eq. (27) and

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}_J} := \left\{ (\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{x} = (c \in \mathbb{C}, \mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log m}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{E}), \\ \mathfrak{w} = \mathbf{f} \in R_q^n \quad \text{s.t.} \\ \text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1 \wedge \langle (\mathbf{M}_J \mathbf{f}), \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = \mathbf{v} \end{array} \right\}. \quad (30)$$

The reduction protocol Π_{rg} is described in Figure 2. We give a high-level overview below.

1. Step 1-3: The prover computes a projected matrix $\mathbf{H}$ from a small projection matrix $\mathbf{J}$, reducing the range-check task from $\text{cf}(\mathbf{f})$ to $\mathbf{H}$. Towards this, the prover decomposes $\mathbf{H}$ into k_g parts $(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})_{i \in [k_g]}$ and encodes $\mathbf{H}^{(i)}$'s entries using monomials. Finally, the prover sends commitments $(c^{(i)})_i$ to these monomial encodings $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_i$.
2. Step 4-5: The parties run the monomial RoK from Lemma 3.1 to ensure that $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_i$ are monomials. To ensure every entry of $(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})_{i \in [k_g]}$ is in the range $(-d/2, d/2)$, the protocol checks that each entry matches the *constant term* of the product of the table polynomial $t(X)$ and the corresponding monomial. Instead of checking entries individually, the protocol reduces these equations into a single evaluation claim at a random point. Namely, at Step 5, the verifier checks that the random evaluations $(u^{(i)})_i$ for the monomials $(g^{(i)})_i$ are consistent with the evaluations $(\langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{v}^{(i)} \rangle)_i$ for $(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})_i$.
3. Step 6-7: The prover outputs the witness vectors $\mathbf{f}$ and $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_i$; the verifier combines the evaluation claims for $(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})_i$ into an $\mathbb{E}$ -element to be consistent with $\mathbf{f}$.

Remark 3.1. Our approximate range proofs require fewer monomial commitments than LatticeFold+[BC25] and therefore avoid the added complexity of folding the so-called *double commitments*. Compared to LaBRADOR [BS23], our construction improves the verifier complexity from linear to polylogarithmic in n .

Theorem 3.1. Π_{rg} in Figure 2 is a RoK from $\mathcal{R}_{\text{rg}}^{\ell_h, B}$ to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}_J} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ w.r.t. relaxed input relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{rg}}^{\ell_h, B'}$ where $B' = 16B_{d,k_g}/\sqrt{30}$. The completeness error is $\epsilon \approx n\lambda_{\text{pj}}d/(\ell_h \cdot 2^{141})$.

Proof. We show that Π_{rg} is ϵ -complete and knowledge sound w.r.t. $\mathcal{R}_{\text{rg}}^{\ell_h, B'}$.

Parameters: $\ell_h \in \mathbb{N}$, $B \in \mathbb{R}$, $d' := d - 2$, $m := n\lambda_{\text{pj}}/\ell_h$ with $md = n$, B_{d,k_g} in Eq. (28), $t(X) \in R_q$ in Eq. (3), and index $\mathfrak{i}$ in Eq. (20)

Input: $\mathfrak{x} = c \in \mathbb{C}$ and $\mathfrak{w} = \mathbf{f} \in R_q^n$

Output instance: $\mathfrak{x}_o = (\mathfrak{x}^*, \mathfrak{x}_{\text{bat}})$ where $\mathfrak{x}^* = (c, \mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log m}, v \in \mathbb{E})$, and

$$\mathfrak{x}_{\text{bat}} = (\mathbf{r}' := (\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{s}) \in \mathbb{K}^{\log n}, [c^{(i)} \in \mathbb{C}, u^{(i)} \in \mathbb{E}]_{i=1}^{k_g}). \quad (31)$$

Output witness: $\mathfrak{w}_o = (\mathbf{f} \in R_q^n, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)} \in \mathcal{M}^n)_{i=1}^{k_g})$

The protocol $\langle P(\mathfrak{x}; \mathfrak{w}); V(\mathfrak{x}) \rangle$:

1. $V \rightarrow P$: Send projection matrix $\mathbf{J} \leftarrow \chi^{\lambda_{\text{pj}} \times \ell_h}$
2. P : Let $\mathbf{H} := (\mathbf{I}_{n/\ell_h} \otimes \mathbf{J}) \times \text{cf}(\mathbf{f}) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m \times d}$. Abort if $\|\mathbf{H}\|_\infty > B_{d,k_g}$. Otherwise, decompose $\mathbf{H}$ as

$$\mathbf{H} = \mathbf{H}^{(1)} + d'\mathbf{H}^{(2)} + \dots + d'^{k_g-1}\mathbf{H}^{(k_g)} \quad (32)$$

where $\|\mathbf{H}^{(i)}\|_\infty \leq d'/2$ for all $i \in [k_g]$. Flatten $(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$ to $(\mathbf{h}^{(i)} := \text{flt}(\mathbf{H}^{(i)}))_{i=1}^{k_g}$

3. $P \rightarrow V$: For $i \in [k_g]$, send $c^{(i)} := \mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{g}^{(i)} \in \mathbb{C}$ where $\mathbf{g}^{(i)} := \text{Exp}(\mathbf{h}^{(i)}) \in \mathcal{M}^n$
4. $P \leftrightarrow V$: Run protocol Π_{mon} in Lemma 3.1 on input $((c^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g})$
 - At the end of round $\log(m)$, upon receiving the sumcheck challenge $\mathbf{r} \leftarrow \mathbb{K}^{\log(m)}$, P sends $\mathbf{v}^{(i)} := \mathbf{H}^{(i)\top} \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \in \mathbb{K}^d$ for $i \in [k_g]$
 - Let $\mathbf{s} \leftarrow \mathbb{K}^{\log d}$ be the last $\log(d)$ challenges, and for $i \in [k_g]$, let $u^{(i)} := \langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{g}^{(i)} \rangle \in \mathbb{E}$. Π_{mon} reduces to checking

$$(\mathfrak{x}_{\text{bat}} = ((\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{s}), [c^{(i)}, u^{(i)}]_{i=1}^{k_g}), (\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}. \quad (\text{Eq. (27)})$$

5. V : For $i \in [k_g]$, compute $u^{(i)} \cdot t(X) \in \mathbb{E}$ and write it as the $\mathbb{K}$ -vector space form

$$[ut_1^{(i)}, \dots, ut_d^{(i)}] \in \mathbb{K}^{1 \times d}.$$

Reject if there exists $i \in [k_g]$ such that $ut_1^{(i)} \neq \langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{v}^{(i)} \rangle$, where $\mathbf{v}^{(i)}$ is the value received at Step 4 (that is supposed to be $\mathbf{H}^{(i)\top} \text{ts}(\mathbf{r})$)

6. V : Set $\mathfrak{x}^* := (c, \mathbf{r}, v \in \mathbb{E})$ where v 's $\mathbb{K}$ -vector space representation is

$$v := \left(\mathbf{v}^{(1)} + d'\mathbf{v}^{(2)} + \dots + d'^{k_g-1}\mathbf{v}^{(k_g)} \right)^\top \in \mathbb{K}^{1 \times d}. \quad (33)$$

Output $\mathfrak{x}_o := (\mathfrak{x}^*, \mathfrak{x}_{\text{bat}})$ where $\mathfrak{x}_{\text{bat}}$ is defined in Eq. (31)

7. P : output $\mathfrak{w}_o = (\mathbf{f} \in R_q^n, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)} \in \mathcal{M}^n)_{i=1}^{k_g})$

Figure 2: The protocol Π_{rg} to reduce $\mathcal{R}_{\text{rg}}^{\ell_h, B}$ to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}, J} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$.

Completeness. If the input $(\mathbf{z} = c, \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{f}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\mathbf{rg}}^{\ell_h, B}$, we first show that

- $\mathbf{P}^*$ aborts in Step 2 with probability at most ϵ . This holds because the projected matrix $\|\mathbf{H}\|_\infty \leq 9.5B \leq B_{d, k_g}$ with probability $1 - \epsilon$, by Eq. (28) and a union bound on Eq. (5).
- In Step 5, the verifier check $ut_1^{(i)} = \langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{v}^{(i)} \rangle$ passes for all $i \in [k_g]$, because
 - $\mathbf{v}^{(i)} = \mathbf{H}^{(i)\top} \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r})$ by definition.
 - $u^{(i)} = \langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \text{Exp}(\mathbf{h}^{(i)}) \rangle \in \mathbb{E}$ by definition. Hence, by viewing $\mathbb{E}$ as an R_q -module, $u^{(i)} \cdot t(X)$ equals $\langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \text{Exp}(\mathbf{h}^{(i)}) \cdot t(X) \rangle$.
 - By viewing $\mathbb{E}$ as a $\mathbb{K}$ -vector space, the first column $ut_1^{(i)}$ of $u^{(i)} \cdot t(X)$ equals $\langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \text{ct}(\text{Exp}(\mathbf{h}^{(i)}) \cdot t(X)) \rangle$.
 - By Lemma 2.1, for all $i \in [k_g]$, $\text{ct}(\text{Exp}(\mathbf{h}^{(i)}) \cdot t(X)) = \text{flt}(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})$. Thus,

$$\begin{aligned} ut_1^{(i)} &= \langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \text{ct}(\text{Exp}(\mathbf{h}^{(i)}) \cdot t(X)) \rangle = \langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \text{flt}(\mathbf{H}^{(i)}) \rangle \\ &= \langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{H}^{(i)\top} \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = \langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{v}^{(i)} \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

Next, we show that the output instance-witness pairs are valid:

- $((c, \mathbf{r}, v), \mathbf{f}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}, J}$. Since c is a commitment to $\mathbf{f}$, it suffices to prove the linear statement $\langle (\mathbf{M}_J \mathbf{f}), \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle = v$, where $\mathbf{M}_J := \mathbf{I}_{n/\ell_h} \otimes \mathbf{J}$. By defining $\mathbf{H} := (\mathbf{I}_{n/\ell_h} \otimes \mathbf{J}) \times \text{cf}(\mathbf{f})$, we simply need to check that $\mathbf{H}^\top \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}) = v^\top \in \mathbb{K}^d$ (treating $v \in \mathbb{E}$ as an element in $\mathbb{K}^{1 \times d}$). Recall that, by Step 4, $\mathbf{v}^{(i)} = \mathbf{H}^{(i)\top} \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r})$ for all $i \in [k_g]$. Consequently, the equality $v^\top = \mathbf{H}^\top \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r})$ follows from Eq. (32) and Eq. (33).
- $(\mathbf{z}_{\text{bat}}, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$. This holds by assignments of $c^{(i)}, u^{(i)}$ in Step 3, 4.

Knowledge soundness. Knowledge extraction is simple. Consider an adversary $\mathbf{P}^*$. The extractor simulates the protocol with $\mathbf{P}^*$, and from $\mathbf{P}^*$'s output $\mathbf{w}_o = (\mathbf{f}, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g})$, it returns $\mathbf{f}$. We first provide some intuition about $\mathbf{f}$'s validity (i.e., $\mathbf{f}$ is of low-norm).

- With high probability, $\mathbf{f}$ is low-norm if its random projection $\mathbf{H}$ is low-norm.
- $\mathbf{H}$ is low-norm if it can be decomposed to $(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})_i$ with low-norm entries.
- $(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})_i$ are low-norm if the witness vectors $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_i$ are monomials and the constant terms of the products $t(X) \cdot \mathbf{g}^{(i)}$ match the entries of $(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})$. The monomial property is checked by the RoK Π_{mon} ; the constant-term consistency is checked in Step 5.

We now give a more formal soundness analysis. Define E as the event that the verifier checks pass and $(\mathbf{z}_o, \mathbf{w}_o)$ is in the output relation, but $(c, \mathbf{f}) \notin \mathcal{R}_{\mathbf{rg}}^{\ell_h, B'}$ where c is the input commitment chosen by $\mathbf{P}^*$. Observe that E occurs only if at least one of the following bad events occurs.

- **Bad Event 1:** The input norm check $\text{VfyOpen}_{\ell_h, B'}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f})$ (Eq. (12)) fails for $B' = 16B_{d, k_g}/\sqrt{30}$, but the random projection $\mathbf{H} := (\mathbf{I}_{n/\ell_h} \otimes \mathbf{J}) \times \text{cf}(\mathbf{f})$ has infinity norm $\|\mathbf{H}\|_\infty \leq B_{d, k_g}$. Recall $\lambda_{\text{pj}} := 256$ and write

$$\mathbf{H} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{H}_{1,1} & \cdots & \mathbf{H}_{1,d} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \mathbf{H}_{m/\lambda_{\text{pj}},1} & \cdots & \mathbf{H}_{m/\lambda_{\text{pj}},d} \end{bmatrix}$$

where $\mathbf{H}_{i,j} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{\lambda_{\text{pj}}}$ for $i \in [m/\lambda_{\text{pj}}], j \in [d]$. $\|\mathbf{H}\|_\infty \leq B_{d, k_g}$ implies that $\|\mathbf{H}_{i,j}\|_2 \leq \sqrt{\lambda_{\text{pj}}} \cdot B_{d, k_g} = 16B_{d, k_g} = \sqrt{30}B'$ for all $i \in [m/\lambda_{\text{pj}}], j \in [d]$. Since $\mathbf{f}$ is bound to c (as $(\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o)$ is valid by assumption), by Eq. (6) of Lemma 2.2, this event happens with probability at most 2^{-128} .

- **Bad Event 2:** $\mathbf{P}^*$'s output $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$ are not monomial vectors. By Lemma 3.1, this happens with negligible probability.
- **Bad Event 3:** $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$ are monomial vectors, but the random projection $\mathbf{H}$ has infinity norm $\|\mathbf{H}\|_\infty > B_{d, k_g}$. For $i \in [k_g]$, define $\mathbf{H}^{(i)} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m \times d}$ such that

$$\text{flt}(\mathbf{H}^{(i)}) = \text{ct}(\mathbf{g}^{(i)} \cdot t(X)) \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{md}. \quad (34)$$

By Lemma 2.1, each component $\mathbf{H}^{(i)}$ is small, i.e., $\|\mathbf{H}^{(i)}\|_\infty \leq d'/2$ for all $i \in [k_g]$. Recall that $\|\mathbf{H}\|_\infty > B_{d, k_g}$, thus it cannot be the weighted sum of these small components, that is,

$$\mathbf{H} \neq \mathbf{H}^{(1)} + d'\mathbf{H}^{(2)} + \cdots + d'^{k_g-1}\mathbf{H}^{(k_g)}. \quad (35)$$

We first show that for each $i \in [k_g]$, $\langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{H}^{(i)\top} \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle$ matches the evaluation $\langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{v}^{(i)} \rangle$:

- Since $(\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o)$ is a valid output, $u^{(i)} = \langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{g}^{(i)} \rangle$ for $i \in [k_g]$.
- Treating $\mathbb{E}$ as an R_q -module and multiplying by the table polynomial, $u^{(i)} \cdot t(X)$ equals $\langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{g}^{(i)} \cdot t(X) \rangle$.
- Treating $\mathbb{E}$ as a $\mathbb{K}$ -vector space, the 1st column $ut_1^{(i)}$ (of $ut^{(i)}$) effectively extracts the constant terms, that is, $\langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \text{ct}(\mathbf{g}^{(i)} \cdot t(X)) \rangle$, which simplifies to $\langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}|\mathbf{s}), \text{flt}(\mathbf{H}^{(i)}) \rangle = \langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{H}^{(i)\top} \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle$ by definition of $\text{flt}(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})$ (Eq. (34)).
- $ut_1^{(i)} = \langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{v}^{(i)} \rangle$ by the check at Step 5. Thus the claim holds.

The above implies that, with overwhelming probability over $\mathbf{s}$, $\mathbf{H}^{(i)\top} \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) = \mathbf{v}^{(i)}$ for all $i \in [k_g]$. Given the assumption $((c, \mathbf{r}, v), \mathbf{f}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}, J}$, we know $\mathbf{H}^\top \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) = v^\top$ for $\mathbf{H} := (\mathbf{I}_{n/\ell_h} \otimes \mathbf{J}) \times \text{cf}(\mathbf{f})$. Combining this with the verifier check in Eq. (33),

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{H}^\top \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) &= v^\top = \left(\mathbf{v}^{(1)} + d'\mathbf{v}^{(2)} + \cdots + d'^{k_g-1}\mathbf{v}^{(k_g)} \right) \\ &= \left(\mathbf{H}^{(1)\top} \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) + d'\mathbf{H}^{(2)\top} \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) + \cdots + d'^{k_g-1}\mathbf{H}^{(k_g)\top} \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \right) \\ &= \left(\mathbf{H}^{(1)} + d'\mathbf{H}^{(2)} + \cdots + d'^{k_g-1}\mathbf{H}^{(k_g)} \right)^\top \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}). \end{aligned}$$

In sum, the above equation holds if the bad event happens. However, since the commitments to $\mathbf{g}^{(i)}$ ($1 \leq i \leq k_g$) are fixed before the verifier samples $\mathbf{r}$, and the weighted sum of $(\mathbf{H}^{(i)})_i$ do not match $\mathbf{H}$ (by Eq. (35)), this equation can only hold with negligible probability over $\mathbf{r}$, and thus the bad event happens with negligible probability.

Thus, E occurs with negligible probability and knowledge soundness holds. $\square$

Proposition 3.3. Π_{rg} in Figure 2 runs a single degree-3 sumcheck protocol over $\mathbb{K}$ of size n . The additional complexity beyond the sumcheck is as follows:

- **Prover cost** $T_p^{\text{rg}}(k_g, n)$: $nd\lambda_{\text{pj}}$ low-norm $\mathbb{Z}$ -additions (Step 2), $O(k_g\kappa n)$ R_q -additions (Step 3), $O(n)$ $\mathbb{K}$ -ops (Step 4), and $T_p^{\text{mon}}(k_g, n)$.
- **Verifier cost** $T_v^{\text{rg}}(k_g, n)$: $k_g t$ R_q -ops and d $\mathbb{K}$ -ops (Step 5), $k_g d$ scalar multiplications between $\mathbb{Z}_q$ and $\mathbb{K}$ (Step 6), and $T_v^{\text{mon}}(k_g, n)$.
- **Verifier randomness** $\Gamma_v^{\text{rg}}(k_g, n)$: $\lambda_{\text{pj}}\ell_h$ bits plus the randomness for Π_{mon} .

4 High-Arity Folding for NP-Complete Relations

In this section, we present a high-arity folding scheme for committed NP statements. Section 4.1 introduces a generalized committed R1CS relation designed for real-world applications, particularly SIMD (Single Instruction Multiple Data) computations. Section 4.2 then describes an *interactive* folding protocol that compresses a large number (e.g. 1024) of generalized R1CS statements. Later in Section 5, we will provide a generic paradigm to transform these interactive folding protocols into *non-interactive* ones.

4.1 Generalized Committed R1CS Relation

In this section, we define the **generalized committed R1CS relation** $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}$. The definition naturally extends to customizable constraint systems (CCS) [STW23] and is particularly suited for capturing SIMD computations.

Formally, setting auxiliary parameters

$$\text{aux} := (n_{\text{in}}, n_w, n := n_{\text{in}} + n_w, \ell_h \in \mathbb{N}, B \in \mathbb{R}, (\mathbf{M}_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m \times n})_{i=1}^3). \quad (36)$$

The generalized R1CS relation is defined as follows:

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}} := \left\{ (\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathbf{x} = (c \in \mathbb{C}, \mathbf{X}_{\text{in}} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n_{\text{in}} \times d}), \quad \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{W} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n_w \times d} \quad \text{s.t.} \\ \mathbf{F}^\top := [\mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}^\top, \mathbf{W}^\top] \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{d \times n} \quad \text{s.t.} \\ (\mathbf{M}_1 \times \mathbf{F}) \circ (\mathbf{M}_2 \times \mathbf{F}) = \mathbf{M}_3 \times \mathbf{F} \\ \wedge \text{VfyOpen}_{\ell_h, B}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{F})) = 1 \end{array} \right\}. \quad (37)$$

We can view this as checking d R1CS statements over $\mathbb{Z}_q$ in a batch. However, the witnesses in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}}$ must be low-norm. To handle standard R1CS statements over $\mathbb{Z}_q$ with *arbitrary* witnesses, we apply the following standard trick.

Let q be a prime, choose a base $b \in \mathbb{N}$, and set $k_{\text{cs}} := 1 + \lfloor \log_b(q) \rfloor$. Given the original R1CS matrices $(\bar{\mathbf{M}}_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m \times \bar{n}})_{i=1}^3$, we define the new R1CS matrices as

$$(\mathbf{M}_i := \bar{\mathbf{M}}_i \otimes [1, b, \dots, b^{k_{\text{cs}}-1}] \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m \times n})_{i=1}^3$$

where $n := \bar{n}k_{\text{cs}}$. Given the original instance-witness pairs $(x_{\text{in}}^{(i)} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{\bar{n}_{\text{in}}}, \mathbf{w}^{(i)} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{\bar{n}_w})_{i=1}^d$, an honest prover sets the converted instance $\mathbf{x}$ and witness $\mathbf{w}$ as

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{x} &:= \left(c, \mathbf{X}_{\text{in}} := \left[\text{decomp}_{b, k_{\text{cs}}}(x_{\text{in}}^{(1)}) \parallel \dots \parallel \text{decomp}_{b, k_{\text{cs}}}(x_{\text{in}}^{(d)}) \right] \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n_{\text{in}} \times d} \right) \\ \mathbf{w} &:= \mathbf{W} = \left[\text{decomp}_{b, k_{\text{cs}}}(\mathbf{w}^{(1)}) \parallel \dots \parallel \text{decomp}_{b, k_{\text{cs}}}(\mathbf{w}^{(d)}) \right] \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n_w \times d}, \end{aligned}$$

where $(n_{\text{in}}, n_w) = (\bar{n}_{\text{in}}, \bar{n}_w) \cdot k_{\text{cs}}$ and c is the commitment to $\mathbf{F}$ as in Eq. (37). It then proves the relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}}$ where the parameter **aux** is defined as

$$n_{\text{in}} = \bar{n}_{\text{in}}k_{\text{cs}}, \quad n_w = \bar{n}_wk_{\text{cs}}, \quad n = n_{\text{in}} + n_w, \quad \ell_h \in \mathbb{N}, \quad B = 0.5b\sqrt{\ell_h}, \quad (\mathbf{M}_i)_{i=1}^3.$$

First, if the prover is honest, the converted statement will be in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}}$ because

1. Each entry of $\mathbf{F}$ is bounded by $b/2$, so the commitment opening relation holds for bound B .
2. Denote by $\mathbf{f}^{(j)} := (x_{\text{in}}^{(j)}, \mathbf{w}^{(j)})$ for all $j \in [d]$. The Hadamard product condition preserves since for every $i \in [3]$, $j \in [d]$,

$$\bar{\mathbf{M}}_i \times \mathbf{f}^{(j)} = (\bar{\mathbf{M}}_i \otimes [1, b, \dots, b^{k_{\text{cs}}-1}]) \times \text{decomp}_{b, k_{\text{cs}}}(\mathbf{f}^{(j)}) = \mathbf{M}_i \times \mathbf{F}_{*,j}.$$

On the other hand, if we know a witness⁸ $\mathbf{W}$ for $(c, \mathbf{X}_{\text{in}})$, where the Hadamard product condition (under $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}}$) holds and the opening $\mathbf{F}^\top := [\mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}^\top, \mathbf{W}^\top]$ is bound to commitment c , then we can recover a witness for the original R1CS statements by combining every k_{cs} rows of $\mathbf{W}$ with the coefficients $[1, b, \dots, b^{k_{\text{cs}}-1}]$.

SIMD computations vs a single instance. The transformation above is particularly suited for capturing *SIMD* computations. To capture a *single* R1CS statement over $\mathbb{Z}_q$, we can adapt the transformation and embed the instance-witness pair into the first column of $\mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}$ and $\mathbf{W}$. However, a more efficient approach is to use the encoding from Neo [NS25], which does not increase the number of rows in the witness matrix.

Define a $\mathbb{Z}_q$ -module homomorphism $\phi : R_q \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_q$ that maps a polynomial $v(X) = \sum_{i=0}^{d-1} v_i X^i \in R_q$ to $v(b) \in \mathbb{Z}_q$ for a small base $b \in \mathbb{Z}$. This allows us to transform an R1CS-like statement

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{r1cs}} := \left\{ (\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathbf{x} = \perp, \quad \mathbf{w} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^n \quad \text{s.t.} \\ (\mathbf{M}_1 \times \mathbf{w}) \circ (\mathbf{M}_2 \times \mathbf{w}) = \mathbf{M}_3 \times \mathbf{w} \end{array} \right\} \quad (38)$$

⁸The low-norm $\mathbf{W}$ is not necessarily of ℓ_∞ -norm less than $b/2$.

into a committed relation where the witness $\mathbf{f} \in R_q^n$ is a *low-norm* vector satisfying $\phi(\mathbf{f}) := (\phi(\mathbf{f}_1), \dots, \phi(\mathbf{f}_n)) = \mathbf{w}$ and $\|\mathbf{f}\|_\infty \leq b/2$:

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{r1cs}} := \left\{ (\mathbf{z}, \mathbf{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathbf{z} = c \in \mathbb{C}, \quad \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{f} \in R_q^n \quad \text{s.t.} \\ (\mathbf{M}_1 \times \phi(\mathbf{f})) \circ (\mathbf{M}_2 \times \phi(\mathbf{f})) = \mathbf{M}_3 \times \phi(\mathbf{f}) \wedge \text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1 \end{array} \right\}. \quad (39)$$

Importantly, $\mathbf{f}$ stays as a vector of length n rather than $\bar{n} = n \cdot k_{\text{cs}}$. Neo [NS25] presents a sumcheck protocol to reduce this committed relation to the linear relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$ (as per Eq. (23)), with a logic similar to Π_{had} as in Figure 1. By substituting Π_{had} with Neo’s sumcheck protocol, all folding protocols in our work can efficiently support single instance proofs without expanding witness matrices vertically.

4.2 The High-Arity Folding Scheme

We present a folding scheme that compresses $\ell_{\text{np}} = \text{poly}(\lambda)$ (generalized) R1CS statements into two committed linear statements.

Single-instance reduction. To build intuition, we first describe a reduction for a single R1CS instance before presenting the full folding scheme.

Fix R1CS parameter aux from Eq. (36). We construct an RoK from $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}}$ (Eq. (37)) to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}_{\text{cs}}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ where $\mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ is defined in Eq. (27). Intuitively, $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}_{\text{cs}}}$ is a linear relation w.r.t. the input witness, and $\mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ checks k_g linear statements w.r.t. the helper monomial vectors $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_i$ for range proof. The parameter aux_{cs} is given by:

$$\text{aux}_{\text{cs}} := (n_{\text{in}}, (\mathbf{M}_i)_{i=1}^4), \quad (45)$$

where $n_{\text{in}}, (\mathbf{M}_i)_{i=1}^3$ are the same as in aux , and $\mathbf{M}_4 := \mathbf{I}_{n/\ell_h} \otimes \mathbf{J}$ for a random $\mathbf{J} \leftarrow \chi^{\lambda_{\text{pj}} \times \ell_h}$. Denote by m and m_J the number of rows of $(\mathbf{M}_i)_{i=1}^3$ and $\mathbf{M}_4$, respectively. WLOG, we assume that they are all powers-of-two and $m_J \leq m \leq n$. The scheme naturally extends to more general choices of parameters.

The protocol Π_{gr1cs} is described in Figure 3. Informally, it interleaves the approximate range proof Π_{rg} (Figure 2) with the Hadamard proof Π_{had} (Figure 1).

Lemma 4.1. *Let aux be the R1CS parameter defined in Eq. (36). Define aux' as aux except that the norm bound B is replaced with $B' = 16B_{d, k_g}/\sqrt{30}$. Π_{gr1cs} in Figure 3 is a reduction of knowledge from $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}}$ (Eq. (37)) to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}_{\text{cs}}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$, with the relaxed input relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'}$. Here, $\mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ is from Eq. (27) and aux_{cs} is defined in Eq. (45). The completeness error ϵ matches that of Theorem 3.1.*

Proof. We show that Π_{gr1cs} is ϵ -complete and knowledge sound w.r.t. $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'}$.

Completeness. Let $(\mathbf{z} := (c, \mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}), \mathbf{w} := \mathbf{W})$ be the input. Set $\mathbf{F}^\top := [\mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}^\top, \mathbf{W}^\top]$ and $\mathbf{f} := \mathbf{c}\mathbf{f}^{-1}(\mathbf{F})$. Denote by the output as

$$\mathbf{z}_o := (\mathbf{z}^* = (c, \mathbf{c}\mathbf{f}^{-1}(\mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}), \mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v} := (\mathbf{v}' \in \mathbb{E}^3, v \in \mathbb{E})), \mathbf{z}_{\text{bat}}), \quad \mathbf{w}_o := (\mathbf{f}, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}).$$

Parameters: $(\mathbf{M}_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m \times n})_{i=1}^3$, $m_J := n\lambda_{\text{pj}}/\ell_h$ with $m_J \leq m \leq n$

Input: $\mathbf{x} = (c \in \mathbb{C}, \mathbf{X}_{\text{in}} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n_{\text{in}} \times d})$, $\mathbf{w} = \mathbf{W} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n_w \times d}$

Output instance: $\mathbf{x}_o = (\mathbf{x}^*, \mathbf{x}_{\text{bat}})$ where

$$\mathbf{x}^* = (c, x_{\text{in}} \in R_q^{n_{\text{in}}}, \mathbf{r} := (\bar{\mathbf{r}} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log(m_J)}, \bar{\mathbf{s}}) \in \mathbb{K}^{\log(m)}, \mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{E}^4) \quad (40)$$

$$\mathbf{x}_{\text{bat}} = ((\bar{\mathbf{r}}, \bar{\mathbf{s}}, \mathbf{s}) \in \mathbb{K}^{\log n}, [c^{(i)} \in \mathbb{C}, u^{(i)} \in \mathbb{E}]_{i=1}^{k_g}) \quad (41)$$

Output witness: $\mathbf{w}_o = (\mathbf{f} \in R_q^n, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)} \in \mathcal{M}^n)_{i=1}^{k_g})$

The protocol $\langle \mathbf{P}(\mathbf{x}; \mathbf{w}); \mathbf{V}(\mathbf{x}) \rangle$:

1. $\mathbf{V} \rightarrow \mathbf{P}$: Send challenges below:
 - $\mathbf{J} \leftarrow \chi^{\lambda_{\text{pj}} \times \ell_h}$ in Step 1 of Π_{rg} (Figure 2)
 - $\mathbf{s}' \leftarrow \mathbb{K}^{\log(m)}$, $\alpha \leftarrow \mathbb{K}$ in Step 1 of Π_{had} (Figure 1)
2. $\mathbf{P} \rightarrow \mathbf{V}$: Send helper commitments $(c^{(i)} := \mathbf{A} \times \mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$ in Step 3 of Π_{rg} (Figure 2)
3. $\mathbf{P} \leftrightarrow \mathbf{V}$: Run two sumcheck protocols in parallel^a for
 - the sumcheck claim from Eq. (24) in Step 2 of Π_{had}
 - the sumcheck claim from Π_{mon} in Step 4 of Π_{rg}

The first sumcheck has $\log(m)$ rounds, the second has $\log(n)$ rounds.

The two protocols share the sumcheck challenge

$$(\bar{\mathbf{r}} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log(m_J)}, \bar{\mathbf{s}} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log(m/m_J)}, \mathbf{s} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log(n/m)})$$

4. $\mathbf{P} \leftrightarrow \mathbf{V}$: Execute the rest of Π_{had} and Π_{rg} .
 - Π_{had} outputs

$$\mathbf{x}_{\text{had},o} = (c, \mathbf{r} := (\bar{\mathbf{r}}, \bar{\mathbf{s}}), \mathbf{v}' \in \mathbb{E}^3), \quad \mathbf{w}_{\text{had},o} = \mathbf{f} \in R_q^n \quad (42)$$

- Π_{rg} outputs

$$\mathbf{x}_{\text{rg},o} = \left[\mathbf{x} = (c, \bar{\mathbf{r}}, v \in \mathbb{E}), \mathbf{x}_{\text{bat}} = ((\bar{\mathbf{r}}, \bar{\mathbf{s}}, \mathbf{s}), [c^{(i)}, u^{(i)} \in \mathbb{E}]_{i=1}^{k_g}) \right] \quad (43)$$

$$\mathbf{w}_{\text{rg},o} = (\mathbf{f}, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)} \in \mathcal{M}^n)_{i=1}^{k_g}) \quad (44)$$

5. $\mathbf{V}$: Output $\mathbf{x}_o = (\mathbf{x}^*, \mathbf{x}_{\text{bat}})$ where $\mathbf{x}^* = (c, x_{\text{in}} := \text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}), \mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v} := (\mathbf{v}', v))$ and $\mathbf{x}_{\text{bat}}$ is in Eq. (43)

6. $\mathbf{P}$: Output $\mathbf{w}_o = \mathbf{w}_{\text{rg},o}$

^aWe can further combine the two sumcheck instances to one via random linear combination. We omit this optimization for simplicity.

Figure 3: The protocol Π_{gr1cs} to reduce $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}}$ to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin},k_g}$.

If $(\mathbb{X}, \mathbb{W})$ is in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}}$, then $(c, \mathbf{F})$ is in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{had}}^{\text{aux}}$ and $(c, \mathbf{f})$ is in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{rg}}^{\ell_h, B}$. By the perfect completeness of Π_{had} (Proposition 3.1) and ϵ -completeness of Π_{rg} (Theorem 3.1), with probability $1 - \epsilon$, it holds that $((c, \mathbf{r}, \mathbf{v}'), \mathbf{f})$ is in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$ (Eq. (23)) and $((c, \mathbf{r}, v), \mathbb{X}_{\text{bat}}), \mathbb{W}_o)$ is in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}, J} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ (Eq. (30) and Eq. (27)). This implies that the output is in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ as desired.

Knowledge soundness. Consider an adversary P^* . The extractor simulates the protocol with P^* , and from P^* 's output $\mathbb{W}_o = (\mathbf{f}, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g})$, it parses $\text{cf}(\mathbf{f})$ as $\text{cf}(\mathbf{f})^\top = [\mathbf{X}^\top, \mathbf{W}^\top]$ and returns $\mathbf{W} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n_w \times d}$.

Let $(\mathbb{X}_o, \mathbb{W}_o)$ denote the output instance and witness. If $(\mathbb{X}_o, \mathbb{W}_o)$ is in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$, then by the knowledge soundness of Π_{had} (Proposition 3.1), Π_{rg} (Theorem 3.1), and by definition of $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}}$ (Eq. (45)), with overwhelming probability, we have

$$(c, \mathbf{f}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{rg}}^{\ell_h, B'} \wedge ((c, \text{cf}(\mathbf{f})) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{had}}^{\text{aux}}) \wedge (\mathbf{X} = \mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}).$$

Thus, the extractor outputs a valid witness for $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'}$ as desired. $\square$

Proposition 4.1. Π_{gr1cs} in Figure 3 runs two degree-3 sumcheck protocols over $\mathbb{K}$, one of size n and the other of size m . The additional complexity beyond the sumcheck is:

- **Prover cost:** $T_p^{\text{gr1cs}}(k_g, n, m) := T_p^{\text{had}}(m) + T_p^{\text{rg}}(k_g, n)$.
- **Verifier cost:** $T_v^{\text{gr1cs}}(k_g, n, m) := T_v^{\text{had}}(m) + T_v^{\text{rg}}(k_g, n)$.
- **Verifier randomness:** $\Gamma_v^{\text{gr1cs}}(k_g, n, m) := \Gamma_v^{\text{had}}(m) + \Gamma_v^{\text{rg}}(k_g, n)$.

$T_p^{\text{had}}(m)$, $T_v^{\text{had}}(m)$, $\Gamma_v^{\text{had}}(m)$ are defined in Proposition 3.2; $T_p^{\text{rg}}(k_g, n)$, $T_v^{\text{rg}}(k_g, n)$, $\Gamma_v^{\text{rg}}(k_g, n)$ are defined in Proposition 3.3.

Multi-instances reduction. Figure 4 describes the high-arity folding scheme Π_{fold} :

Step 1-3: Π_{fold} executes ℓ_{np} parallel instances of Π_{gr1cs} (Figure 3) with shared randomness. Naive implementation would run the sumcheck protocol $O(\ell_{\text{np}})$ times. To improve efficiency, we merge the $2\ell_{\text{np}}$ sumcheck instances into two via a random linear combination, and Π_{fold} only requires two parallel sumcheck executions.

Step 4-6: The verifier samples a low-norm challenge vector $\beta \leftarrow \$ \mathcal{S}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$. The commitments, evaluations, and witnesses are then folded with respect to β .

Remark 4.1 (Output compression). Since the output monomial vectors $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$ share the same linear relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, 1}$ (Eq. (27)), they can be folded into a single vector. This gives a reduction from $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, 1}$. We omit this optimization for simplicity.

Remark 4.2 (Memory Efficiency). We describe a prover algorithm for Π_{fold} with roughly the same memory cost as running a single Π_{gr1cs} instance with witness size n . As a tradeoff, the prover takes $2 + \log \log(n)$ passes to the input data.

1. The algorithm starts by computing the ℓ_{np} input commitments in a stream and obtains the first-round random challenges.

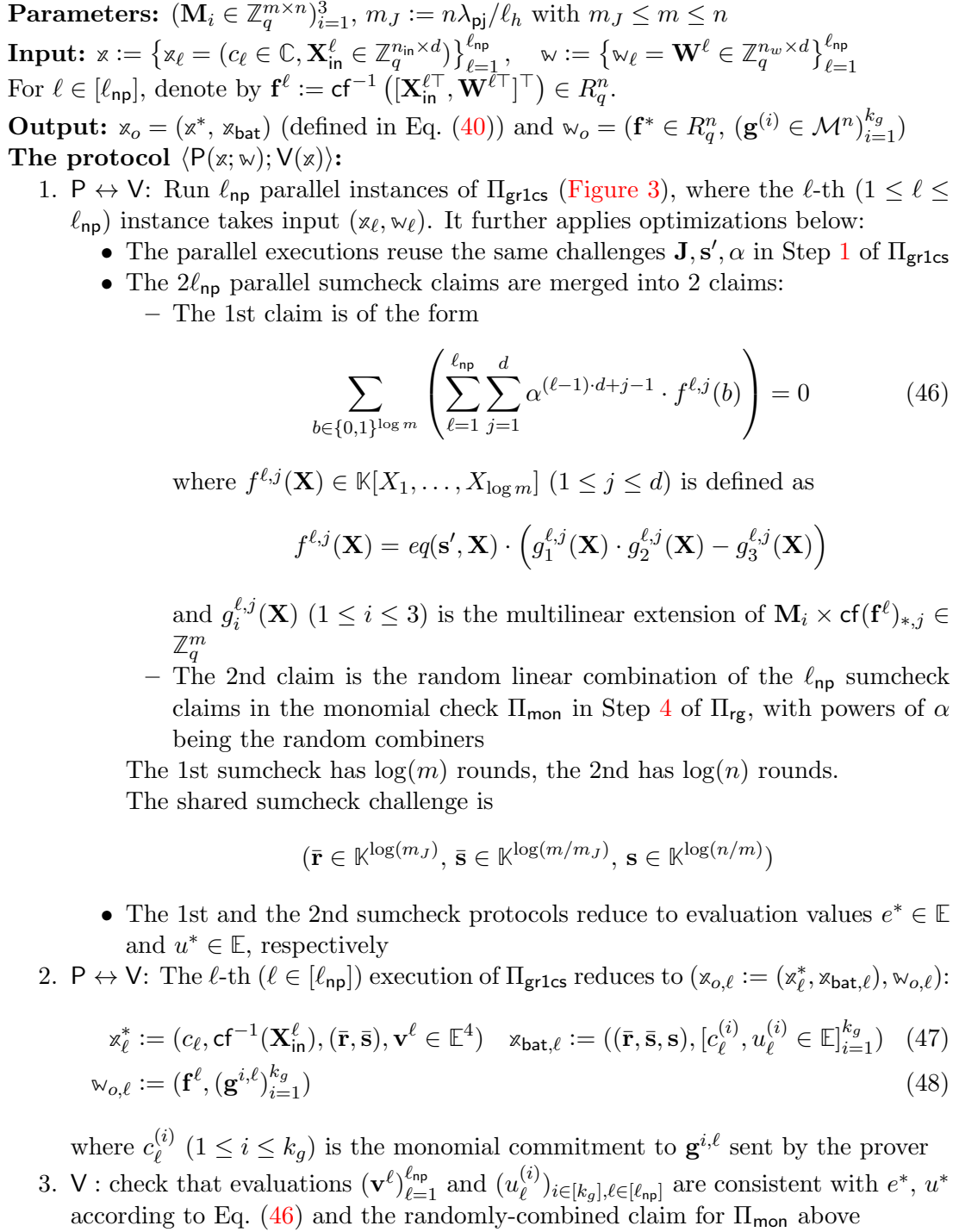


Figure 4: The protocol Π_{fold} to reduce $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}_{\text{cs}}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$: Part I.

4. $V \rightarrow P$: Send low-norm challenge $\beta \leftarrow \mathcal{S}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$
5. V : Set $\mathbb{x}^* := (c^* \in \mathbb{C}, x_{\text{in}}^* \in R_q^{n_{\text{in}}}, (\bar{\mathbf{r}}, \bar{\mathbf{s}}) \in \mathbb{K}^{\log(m)}, \mathbf{v}^* \in \mathbb{E}^4)$ where

$$(c^*, x_{\text{in}}^*, \mathbf{v}^*) := \sum_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}} \beta_{\ell} \cdot (c_{\ell}, \text{cf}^{-1}(\mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}^{\ell}), \mathbf{v}^{\ell}).$$

Set $\mathbb{x}_{\text{bat}} := ((\bar{\mathbf{r}}, \bar{\mathbf{s}}, \mathbf{s}), [c^{(i)} \in \mathbb{C}, u^{(i)} \in \mathbb{E}_{i=1}^{k_g}]$ where for $i \in [k_g]$,

$$(c^{(i)}, u^{(i)}) := \sum_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}} \beta_{\ell} \cdot (c_{\ell}^{(i)}, u_{\ell}^{(i)}). \quad (49)$$

Output $\mathbb{x}_o := (\mathbb{x}^*, \mathbb{x}_{\text{bat}})$

6. P : Output $\mathbb{w}_o = (\mathbf{f}^* \in R_q^n, (\mathbf{g}^{(i)} \in R_q^{n_{k_g}})_{i=1}^{k_g})$ where

$$\mathbf{f}^* := \sum_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}} \beta_{\ell} \cdot \mathbf{f}^{\ell}, \quad \mathbf{g}^{(i)} := \sum_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}} \beta_{\ell} \cdot \mathbf{g}^{i,\ell} \quad (50)$$

Figure 4: The protocol Π_{fold} to reduce $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$: Part II.

2. Once getting the random combiner α , the prover executes the sumcheck using the algorithm from Section 4 of [Baw+25]. For each of the $\log \log(n)$ passes over the input data, the prover computes the sumcheck evaluation table by linearly combining the table of each instance. The sumcheck prover takes time $O(n \log \log(n))$ plus the cost of combining the ℓ_{np} evaluation tables, where the latter is dominant.
3. After executing the sumcheck and deriving the folding challenge β , the prover streams the input witnesses again and combines them into a single folded witness.

Theorem 4.1. *Let aux , aux_{cs} be the parameters defined in Eq. (36) and Eq. (45). Define aux' as aux except that the norm bound B is replaced with $B' = 16B_{d,k_g}/\sqrt{30}$. Assume that **Construction 2.1** is relaxed binding w.r.t. opening space $\mathcal{O}'_{B_{\text{rbnd}}} \times (\mathcal{S} - \mathcal{S})$ (Eq. (8)), where $|\mathcal{S}| = \omega(\text{poly}(\lambda))$, $\mathcal{S} - \mathcal{S}$ is invertible over R_q , and*

$$B_{\text{rbnd}}/2 = B_{\text{bnd}} \geq \ell_{\text{np}} \cdot \|\mathcal{S}\|_{\text{op}} \cdot \max(B \cdot \sqrt{nd/\ell_h}, \sqrt{n}). \quad (51)$$

For $\ell_{\text{np}} = \text{poly}(\lambda)$, Π_{fold} in **Figure 4** is an RoK from $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ (Eq. (37)) to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ (Eq. (27)), with the relaxed input relation $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$. The completeness error is $\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot \epsilon$ with ϵ being the completeness error of Π_{gr1cs} (**Lemma 4.1**).

Remark 4.3. Eq. (51) is a worst-case bound. In practice, the folding challenge β is sampled from a symmetric distribution, the folded witness is expected to have a much lower norm. We leave the concrete probability analysis for future work.

Proof of Theorem 4.1. We show that Π_{fold} is $\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot \epsilon$ -complete and knowledge sound w.r.t. $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$.

Completeness. By the ϵ -completeness of Π_{gr1cs} (Lemma 4.1) and the perfect completeness of sumcheck batching, with probability at least $1 - \ell_{\text{np}} \cdot \epsilon$, Step 3 passes, and each statement in $(\mathbf{x}_{o,\ell}, \mathbf{w}_{o,\ell})_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ (Step 2) is in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin},k_g}$. Next, we show that the folded statement is also in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin},k_g}$:

- After linearly-combining the instances and the witnesses using β , the linear relations under $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}}$ and $\mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin},k_g}$ still holds.
- The folded witnesses are valid openings to the folded commitments: Each input witness $\mathbf{f}^\ell$ ($1 \leq \ell \leq \ell_{\text{np}}$) has ℓ_2 -norm $\leq B \cdot \sqrt{nd/\ell_h}$; each monomial vector $\mathbf{g}^{i,\ell}$ ($i \in [k_g], \ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$) has ℓ_2 -norm $\leq \sqrt{n}$. Thus, the norms of the folded witnesses $\mathbf{f}^*$ and $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$ are bounded by $\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot \|\mathcal{S}\|_{\text{op}} \cdot B \cdot \sqrt{nd/\ell_h}$ and $\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot \|\mathcal{S}\|_{\text{op}} \cdot \sqrt{n}$, respectively. By Eq. (51), the folded witnesses are valid (strict) openings w.r.t. bound B_{bnd} .

Knowledge soundness. We first describe the extractor. WLOG, assume that the adversary $\mathbf{P}^*$ is deterministic. Define folding challenge space $\mathcal{U} := \mathcal{S}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$. Let $\mathcal{Y}$ be the domain of $(\text{tr}, (\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o))$ where tr is the protocol transcript and $(\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o)$ is the output instance-witness pair. Define predicate $\Psi(\mathbf{u} \in \mathcal{U}, \mathbf{y} := (\text{tr}, (\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o)))$ that outputs 1 if and only if (i) tr is an accepting transcript (with folding challenge $\beta = \mathbf{u}$) and (ii) $(\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin},k_g}$. For folding challenge $\mathbf{u}$ and the extra verifier randomness $\mathbf{r}_v$, define $\mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}(\mathbf{u})$ as the adversary that simulates the execution of $\mathbf{P}^*$ with verifier randomness $\mathbf{r}_v$ and folding challenge $\mathbf{u}$. Let Ext_{cwss} be the oracle extractor from Lemma 2.3.

Extractor $\text{Ext}^{\mathcal{A}^*}$:

1. Sample folding challenge $\mathbf{u}_0 \leftarrow \mathcal{S}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ and extra verifier randomness $\mathbf{r}_v$
2. Run extractor $\text{Ext}_{\text{cwss}}^{\mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}(\mathbf{u}_0)}$. Abort if it fails. Otherwise, let the output be

$$\left(\mathbf{u}_\ell, \mathbf{y}_\ell := (\text{tr}_\ell, \mathbf{x}_o^\ell, \mathbf{w}_o^\ell) \right)_{\ell=0}^{\ell_{\text{np}}},$$

where $\Psi(\mathbf{u}_\ell, \mathbf{y}_\ell) = 1$ for all $\ell \in [0, \ell_{\text{np}}]$, and $\mathbf{u}_\ell \equiv_\ell \mathbf{u}_0$ for all $\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$

3. For every $\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$, parse $\mathbf{w}_o^\ell = (\mathbf{f}^{*,\ell}, (\mathbf{g}^{(i,\ell)})_{i=1}^{k_g})$, compute⁹

$$\mathbf{f}^\ell := (\mathbf{f}^{*,\ell} - \mathbf{f}^{*,0}) / (\mathbf{u}_\ell[\ell] - \mathbf{u}_0[\ell]) \in R_q^n, \quad (52)$$

$$\forall i \in [k_g] : \mathbf{h}^{i,\ell} := (\mathbf{g}^{(i,\ell)} - \mathbf{g}^{(i,0)}) / (\mathbf{u}_\ell[\ell] - \mathbf{u}_0[\ell]) \in R_q^n \quad (53)$$

Parse $\mathbf{f}^\ell$ as $\mathbf{f}^\ell := \text{cf}^{-1}([\mathbf{X}^{\ell\top}, \mathbf{W}^{\ell\top}]^\top) \in R_q^n$, abort if $\mathbf{X}^\ell \neq \mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}^\ell$

4. Output $\mathbf{w} := \{\mathbf{w}_\ell = \mathbf{W}^\ell \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n_w \times d}\}_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$

Success probability. Fix verifier randomness $\mathbf{r}_v$ (that excludes folding challenge β). By Lemma 2.3, Step 2 succeeds with probability $\epsilon_\Psi(\mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}) - \ell_{\text{np}}/|\mathcal{S}|$ where

$$\epsilon_\Psi(\mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}) := \Pr_{\mathbf{u} \leftarrow \mathcal{U}} [\Psi(\mathbf{u}, \mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}(\mathbf{u})) = 1].$$

⁹ $\mathbf{f}^\ell$ is well-defined as $\mathbf{u}_\ell[\ell] - \mathbf{u}_0[\ell] \in \mathcal{S} - \mathcal{S}$ is invertible over R_q by assumption.

Let $(c_\ell)_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ denote the input commitments and $(c_\ell^{(i)})_{i \in [k_g], \ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]}$ the monomial commitments. The extracted openings $(\mathbf{f}^\ell, (\mathbf{h}^{i,\ell})_{i=1}^{k_g})_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ satisfy:

- For $\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$, $\mathbf{f}^\ell$ is bound to c_ℓ , with relaxed opening $(\mathbf{f}^{*,\ell} - \mathbf{f}^{*,0}, \mathbf{u}_\ell[\ell] - \mathbf{u}_0[\ell])$ (Eq. (10)).
- For $i \in [k_g], \ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$, $\mathbf{h}^{i,\ell}$ is bound to $c_\ell^{(i)}$, with opening $(\mathbf{g}^{(i,\ell)} - \mathbf{g}^{(i,0)}, \mathbf{u}_\ell[\ell] - \mathbf{u}_0[\ell])$.
- For $\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$, let $\mathbf{x}_{o,\ell}$ be the reduced instance from Eq. (47), and set $\mathbf{w}_{o,\ell} := (\mathbf{f}^\ell, (\mathbf{h}^{i,\ell})_{i=1}^{k_g})_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$. Define $\hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}}, \hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{batchlin}}$ as the relaxed relations of $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}}, \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ where the strict opening check VfyOpen is replaced with the relaxed ones from Eq. (10). Since $\Psi(\mathbf{u}_\ell, \mathbf{y}_\ell) = \Psi(\mathbf{u}_0, \mathbf{y}_0) = 1$, and $\mathbf{u}_\ell \equiv_\ell \mathbf{u}_0$, we get that $(\mathbf{x}_{o,\ell}, \mathbf{w}_{o,\ell}) \in \hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{batchlin}}$.

Let ϵ_{P^*} be the prover P^* 's success probability. Thus, with probability at least $\epsilon_{\text{P}^*} - (\ell_{\text{np}}/|\mathcal{S}|)$ (over $\mathbf{r}_v, \mathbf{u}_0$ and Ext_{cwss} 's randomness), the extractor outputs $(\mathbf{w}_{o,\ell})_{\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]}$ at Step 3 satisfying the relaxed relation $(\hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{batchlin}})_{\text{np}}^\ell$ w.r.t. $(\mathbf{x}_{o,\ell})_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$. By the same soundness argument as Lemma 4.1 (relying on relaxed binding, Eq. (10), instead of strict binding, Eq. (11), of Construction 2.1), and by a union bound, the extractor succeeds with probability

$$\epsilon_{\text{P}^*} - (\ell_{\text{np}}/|\mathcal{S}|) - \ell_{\text{np}} \cdot \text{negl}(\lambda) = \epsilon_{\text{P}^*} - \text{negl}(\lambda),$$

and produces a witness $\mathbf{w} := \{\mathbf{w}_\ell = \mathbf{W}^\ell\}_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ in $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'})_{\text{np}}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ as required. $\square$

Proposition 4.2. Π_{fold} (Figure 4) runs two degree-3 sumcheck protocols¹⁰ over $\mathbb{K}$, with size n and m respectively. Additional complexity beyond sumchecks is:

- **Prover cost** $T_p^{\text{fold}}(\ell_{\text{np}}, k_g, n, m)$:
 - $n\ell_{\text{np}}$ multiplications between $\mathcal{S}$ and R_q (to compute $\mathbf{f}^*$),
 - $k_g n \ell_{\text{np}}$ multiplications between $\mathcal{S}$ and $\mathcal{M} \subseteq R_q$ (to compute $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$),
 - $\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot T_p^{\text{gr1cs}}(k_g, n, m)$.
 - **Verifier cost** $T_v^{\text{fold}}(\ell_{\text{np}}, n_{\text{in}}, k_g, n, m)$:
 - $(1 + k_g)\ell_{\text{np}}$ multiplications between $\mathcal{S}$ and $\mathbb{C} := R_q^\kappa$ (for commitments),
 - $\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot n_{\text{in}}$ multiplications between $\mathcal{S}$ and R_q (for public inputs),
 - $(4 + k_g)t\ell_{\text{np}}$ multiplications between $\mathcal{S}$ and R_q (for evaluations over $\mathbb{E}$),
 - $\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot T_v^{\text{gr1cs}}(k_g, n, m)$.
 - **Verifier randomness:** $\Gamma_v^{\text{fold}}(\ell_{\text{np}}, k_g, n, m) = \Gamma_v^{\text{gr1cs}}(k_g, n, m) + \ell_{\text{np}} \log(|\mathcal{S}|)$.
- $T_p^{\text{gr1cs}}(k_g, n, m)$, $T_v^{\text{gr1cs}}(k_g, n, m)$, and $\Gamma_v^{\text{gr1cs}}(k_g, n, m)$ are defined in Proposition 4.1.

5 The Fiat-Shamir Transform

In this section, we introduce a two-step compiler to make Π_{fold} non-interactive via the Fiat-Shamir transform. The compiler is a generic extension to the ideas behind Protostar [BC23] and lattice double-commitments [BS23; BC25]. Notably, our scheme removes

¹⁰The sumcheck protocol complexity is independent of ℓ_{np} after batching.

the need for the “outer commitments” to be linearly homomorphic and achieves a tighter security bound by using a straightline-extractable outer commitment. In this section, we introduce a two-step compiler to make Π_{fold} non-interactive via the Fiat-Shamir transform. The compiler is a generic extension to the ideas behind Protostar [BC23] and lattice double-commitments [BS23; BC25]. Notably, our scheme removes the need for the “outer commitments” to be linearly homomorphic and achieves a tighter security bound by using a straightline-extractable outer commitment.

The Commit-and-Open transformation. Let Π_{rok} be a $(2\text{rnd} + 1)$ -message public-coin RoK from $\mathcal{R}$ to an output relation $\mathcal{R}_o$, with relaxed input relation $\mathcal{R}'$. Let Π_{cm} be a binding commitment scheme with public parameter pp_{cm} . (Later in Section 6, Π_{cm} will be the polynomial (or vector) commitment scheme used in the commit-and-prove SNARK.) We denote by $\text{CM}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ a variant of Π_{rok} , where each prover message m_i ($i \in [\text{rnd}]$) is replaced with the commitment $c_i := \Pi_{\text{cm}}.\text{Commit}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, m_i)$, and at the end of the protocol, the prover further sends the opening messages $(m_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}$. The verifier (i) runs the original RoK verifier w.r.t. $(m_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}$ and its own verifier challenges, and (ii) checks that $(m_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}$ are the valid openings to the commitments $(c_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}$. With a similar argument as in Protostar [BC23], it is clear that $\text{CM}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ is an RoK if Π_{rok} is, where the input, output and relaxed input relations are the same.

The Fiat-Shamir transform. Next, we denote by $\text{FS}^{\text{H}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ the Fiat-Shamir transformation of $\text{CM}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$, where verifier challenges are derived via a hash function H modeled as a random oracle. The transcript is initialized with $\mathfrak{x}$, and the challenge r_1 is set to $\text{H}(\mathfrak{x})$. For each round $i \in [\text{rnd}]$, the challenge r_i and the commitment $c_i = \Pi_{\text{cm}}.\text{Commit}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, m_i)$ are appended to the transcript, where m_i is the prover message. The next challenge r_{i+1} is then derived from the transcript. Note that in practice, instead of taking the entire transcript as an oracle input, we can use the Merkle-Damgård framework to fix the input length of the hash function.

We emphasize that the folding proof of $\text{FS}^{\text{H}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ contains opening messages $\{m_i\}_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}$ to enable folding verifications. But later in Section 6, the SNARK proofs in Construction 6.1 do not include $\{m_i\}_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}$.

Next, we present a variant of Theorem 4.1, which shows the security of $\text{FS}^{\text{H}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{fold}}]$.

Theorem 5.1. *Let Π_{cm} be a binding commitment scheme that is further straightline extractable.¹¹ Let H be a hash function modeled as a random oracle. Define aux , aux_{cs} , aux' and other parameters as in Theorem 4.1. $\text{FS}^{\text{H}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ is an RoK from $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ (Eq. (37)) to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}_{\text{cs}}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ (Eq. (27)), with the relaxed input relation $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$.*

Proof. The proof is similar to that of Theorem 4.1. Intuitively, the statement holds because (i) the committed sumcheck protocols are still sound after the Fiat-Shamir transform above [Can+19; CMS19] (formally proved in Lemma B.2), and (ii) we can

¹¹Straightline extractability means that an extractor can derive the opening simply from the commitment and the adversary transcript (that includes the queries to the idealized oracle).

replace [Lemma 2.3](#) with a variant in the random oracle model, adapted from Section 8.2 and Figure 13 of [FMN24]. The proof of [Lemma B.2](#) is non-trivial and crucially uses the straightline extractability of Π_{cm} to obtain a tighter security bound. We defer the full proof to [Appendix B](#). $\square$

Remark 5.1. Compared to Π_{fold} , the knowledge error of $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ is increased by a factor of Q – the number of random oracle queries. This is common in known security proofs of the Fiat-Shamir transform. To achieve the same security level, one can enlarge the extension field $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{F}_{q^t}$ and the folding challenge set $\mathcal{S}$. This has only a minor impact on the efficiency of the batched sumcheck protocol and the random linear combinations of the R_q -witness vectors, which are insignificant compared to the cost of committing to the ℓ_{np} input witnesses.

6 SNARKs in the ROM from High-Arity Folding

In this section, we apply the Fiat-Shamir transform ([Section 5](#)) to our high-arity folding scheme [Section 4](#) and combine this with a Commit-and-Prove-SNARK ([Definition 2.8](#)) to construct a succinct proof system in the random oracle model for batch-proving many R1CS statements.

Unlike prior folding-based IVC/SNARKs, our approach avoids instantiating random oracles in SNARK circuits and requires only a *single* folding step. The scheme inherits plausible post-quantum security from the underlying SNARKs. When using hash-based (or pairing-based) SNARKs, the proof size is independent of the number of R1CS statements and grows poly-logarithmically with the *per-statement* witness size. Compared to monolithic CP-SNARKs, our approach improves time and memory efficiency by leveraging the folding scheme to handle the majority of the computational load. The CP-SNARK is only used to prove a small recursive verifier statement.

From (Non-Succinct) RoKs to SNARKs. We start with a modular compiler that transforms a reduction of knowledge into a SNARK. Let $\text{GenR}(1^\lambda) \rightarrow (\mathcal{R}, \mathcal{R}', \mathfrak{i})$ be a relation generator that outputs relation $\mathcal{R}$, relaxed relation $\mathcal{R}'$, and index $\mathfrak{i}$ on input 1^λ . We omit index $\mathfrak{i}$ when clear in context.

Let Π_{rok} be a $(2\text{rnd} + 1)$ -message public-coin RoK from $\mathcal{R}$ to an output relation $\mathcal{R}_o$, with relaxed input relation $\mathcal{R}'$. Denote by $(\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w})$, $(\mathfrak{x}_o, \mathfrak{w}_o)$ the input and output instance-witness pairs, respectively. Here $\text{rnd} = \text{poly}(\log(\lambda))$ and

$$|\mathfrak{x}_o| = \text{poly}(\lambda, |\mathfrak{x}|, \log(|\mathfrak{w}|)). \quad (54)$$

Denote the i -th prover message by $m_i \in \mathcal{M}_{p,i}^*$ ($1 \leq i \leq \text{rnd}$) and the i -th verifier challenge by $r_i \in \mathcal{M}_{v,i}^*$ ($1 \leq i \leq \text{rnd} + 1$). By the public reducibility of RoKs, there is a deterministic function f such that

$$\mathfrak{x}_o := f\left(\mathfrak{x}, (m_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}, (r_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}+1}\right). \quad (55)$$

Define the CP-SNARK relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{cp}}$ with input

$$\mathbb{x}_{\text{cp}} := (\mathbb{x}, (r_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}+1}, (c_{\text{fs},i})_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}, \mathbb{x}_o), \quad \mathbb{w} := (\mathbb{w}_{\text{cp}} := (m_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}, \mathbb{w}_e) \quad (56)$$

which checks Eq. (55) and that $c_{\text{fs},i} = \Pi_{\text{cm}}.\text{Commit}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, m_i)$ for all $i \in [\text{rnd}]$. The commitment scheme Π_{cm} must be straightline extractable but need not be linearly homomorphic. E.g., Merkle commitments used in hash-based CP-SNARKs and KZG commitments used in pairing-based CP-SNARKs both suffice.

Denote by $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ the Fiat-Shamir transformation of $\text{CM}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ defined in Section 5. Again, we emphasize that the folding proof of $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ contains prover messages $\{m_i\}_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}$ to enable folding verifications, but the SNARK proofs in Construction 6.1 do not include $\{m_i\}_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}$.

Construction 6.1. Let H be a hash function modeled as a random oracle. We construct a SNARK Π^* for $\mathcal{R}$ (with relaxed relation $\mathcal{R}'$) using (i) a SNARK Π_{snark} for $\mathcal{R}_o$, and (ii) a CP-SNARK Π_{cp} for $\mathcal{R}_{\text{cp}}$ w.r.t. the commitment Π_{cm} .

Setup: $\text{Setup}(\mathcal{R}) \rightarrow (\text{pk}^*, \text{vk}^*)$:

1. $\text{pp}_{\text{cm}} \leftarrow \Pi_{\text{cm}}.\text{Setup}(1^\lambda)$
2. $(\text{pk}_{\text{cp}}, \text{vk}_{\text{cp}}) \leftarrow \Pi_{\text{cp}}.\text{Setup}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, \mathcal{R}_{\text{cp}})$
3. $(\text{pk}, \text{vk}) \leftarrow \Pi_{\text{snark}}.\text{Setup}(\mathcal{R}_o)$
4. Output $\text{pk}^* := (\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, \text{pk}_{\text{cp}}, \text{pk})$, $\text{vk}^* := (\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, \text{vk}_{\text{cp}}, \text{vk})$

Prover: $\text{Prove}^H(\text{pk}^*, \mathcal{R}, \mathbb{x}, \mathbb{w}) \rightarrow \pi$:

1. Initialize transcript $\text{tr} := \mathbb{x}$
2. For $i \in [\text{rnd}]$:
 - Derive challenge r_i from tr and the hash function H
 - Run Π_{rok} and obtain prover message m_i
 - Append tr with $(r_i, c_{\text{fs},i} := \Pi_{\text{cm}}.\text{Commit}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, m_i))$
3. Derive $r_{\text{rnd}+1}$ and run Π_{rok} to obtain $(\mathbb{x}_o, \mathbb{w}_o)$
4. Compute $\mathbb{w}_e$ such that $(\mathbb{x}_{\text{cp}}, (\mathbb{w}_{\text{cp}}, \mathbb{w}_e)) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{cp}}$ with $(\mathbb{x}_{\text{cp}}, \mathbb{w}_{\text{cp}})$ defined in Eq. (56)
5. $\pi_{\text{cp}} \leftarrow \Pi_{\text{cp}}.\text{Prove}(\text{pk}_{\text{cp}}, \mathcal{R}_{\text{cp}}, \mathbb{x}_{\text{cp}}, \mathbb{w}_{\text{cp}}, \mathbb{w}_e)$
6. $\pi \leftarrow \Pi_{\text{snark}}.\text{Prove}(\text{pk}, \mathcal{R}_o, \mathbb{x}_o, \mathbb{w}_o)$
7. Output $\pi^* := (\pi_{\text{cp}}, \pi, (c_{\text{fs},i})_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}, \mathbb{x}_o)$

Verifier: $\text{Vf}^H(\text{vk}^*, \mathcal{R}, \mathbb{x}, \pi^*) \rightarrow b$:

1. Parse $\pi^* = (\pi_{\text{cp}}, \pi, (c_{\text{fs},i})_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}, \mathbb{x}_o)$
2. Recompute $(r_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}+1}$ from $\mathbb{x}$, $(c_{\text{fs},i})_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}$ and H
3. Derive $\mathbb{x}_{\text{cp}} = (\mathbb{x}, (r_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}+1}, (c_{\text{fs},i})_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}, \mathbb{x}_o)$ as in Eq. (56)
4. Output $\Pi_{\text{cp}}.\text{Vf}(\text{vk}_{\text{cp}}, \mathcal{R}_{\text{cp}}, \mathbb{x}_{\text{cp}}, \pi_{\text{cp}}) \wedge \Pi_{\text{snark}}.\text{Vf}(\text{vk}, \mathcal{R}_o, \mathbb{x}_o, \pi)$

Remark 6.1 (Instance Compression). If $\mathbb{x}$ is large, verifying π_{cp} against $\mathbb{x}$ might be costly. To improve efficiency, we replace $\mathbb{x}$ with a vector commitment $c_{\text{fs},0} := \Pi_{\text{cm}}.\text{Commit}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, \mathbb{x})$. The CP-SNARK, when proving Eq. (55), treats $c_{\text{fs},0}$ as the instance and treats $\mathbb{x}$ as a witness. When verifying the CP-SNARK proof, the verifier replaces $\mathbb{x}$ (in $\mathbb{x}_{\text{cp}}$) with $c_{\text{fs},0}$.

$c_{fs,0}$ is only 32 bytes with Merkle commitments and 48 bytes with KZG commitments. In Π_{fold} where $\mathbb{z}$ contains commitments $(c_\ell)_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{np}}$ and public inputs $(\mathbf{X}_{in}^\ell)_\ell$, the verifier also checks the consistency between $(\mathbf{X}_{in}^\ell)_\ell$ and $c_{fs,0}$ *outside* the circuit.

Remark 6.2 (Optimizing proof sizes). To achieve smaller proof sizes, one option is to generate a single CP-SNARK proof that proves both $(\mathbb{z}_{cp}, (\mathbb{w}_{cp}, \mathbb{w}_e)) \in \mathcal{R}_{cp}$ and $(\mathbb{z}_o, \mathbb{w}_o) \in \mathcal{R}_o$, thus removing the need of an extra SNARK proof π .

Theorem 6.1. *If the RoK Π_{rok} satisfies that $\sum_{i=1}^{rnd+1} |r_i| = \text{poly}(\lambda, |\mathbb{z}|, \log(|\mathbb{w}|))$ where r_i 's are the verifier challenges, then [Construction 6.1](#) is a SNARK w.r.t. the relation generator GenR ([Definition 2.7](#)).*

Proof. We show the succinctness, completeness, and knowledge soundness of Π^* .

Succinctness. The proof is $\pi^* := (\pi_{cp}, \pi, (c_{fs,i})_{i=1}^{rnd}, \mathbb{z}_o)$. We first scrutinize the proof size: (i) π_{cp}, π are succinct by the succinctness of the SNARKs Π_{cp}, Π_{snark} . (ii) The set of commitments $(c_{fs,i})_{i=1}^{rnd}$ is succinct since rnd is polylogarithmic and the commitments are succinct. (iii) $\mathbb{z}_o$ is succinct by assumption (Eq. (54)).

Next, we check verifier complexity: (i) computing $(r_i)_{i=1}^{rnd+1}$ takes a transcript of sublinear size since commitments are succinct and $\sum_{i=1}^{rnd+1} |r_i|$ is sublinear by assumption. (ii) Verifying π_{cp}, π takes sublinear time by the succinctness of Π_{cp}, Π_{snark} .

Completeness. By the SNARK completeness of Π_{snark} and the completeness of Π_{rok} , with overwhelming probability, we have $(\mathbb{z}_o, \mathbb{w}_o) \in \mathcal{R}_o$ and $\Pi_{snark}.Vf(vk, \mathcal{R}_o, \mathbb{z}_o, \pi) = 1$. Likewise, by the SNARK completeness of Π_{cp} and Eq. (55), $(\mathbb{z}_{cp}, (\mathbb{w}_{cp}, \mathbb{w}_e)) \in \mathcal{R}_{cp}$ and $\Pi_{cp}.Vf(vk_{cp}, \mathcal{R}_{cp}, \mathbb{z}_{cp}, \pi_{cp}) = 1$. Thus, the verifier accepts with overwhelming probability if the prover is honest.

Knowledge soundness. Let P^* be a malicious prover for Π^* . We first construct an adversary $\mathcal{A}$ against the RoK $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{cm}, \Pi_{rok}]$ (where $\mathcal{A}$ depends on P^*):

1. Run the extractor of Π_{cp} to obtain witness $(\mathbb{w}_{cp}, \mathbb{w}_e)$. Let $\mathbb{z}_{cp} := (\mathbb{z}, (r_i)_{i=1}^{rnd+1}, (c_{fs,i})_{i=1}^{rnd}, \mathbb{z}_o)$ be the CP-SNARK instance, where $\mathbb{z}$ is the SNARK instance, $(c_{fs,i})_{i=1}^{rnd}, \mathbb{z}_o$ are parts of the SNARK proof π^* , all output by P^* . The challenges $(r_i)_{i=1}^{rnd+1}$ are derived from $\mathbb{z}, (c_{fs,i})_{i=1}^{rnd}$ and the hash function H . Abort if $(\mathbb{z}_{cp}, (\mathbb{w}_{cp}, \mathbb{w}_e)) \notin \mathcal{R}_{cp}$
2. Run the extractor of Π_{snark} to obtain witness $\mathbb{w}_o$ w.r.t. the instance $\mathbb{z}_o$ underlying $\mathbb{z}_{cp}$. Abort if $(\mathbb{z}_o, \mathbb{w}_o) \notin \mathcal{R}_o$
3. Output instance $\mathbb{z}_o$, witness $\mathbb{w}_o$, the round commitments $(c_{fs,i})_{i=1}^{rnd}$, and the opening prover messages $(m_i)_{i=1}^{rnd}$ underlying $\mathbb{w}_{cp}$

Let ϵ_{P^*} be the success probability of P^* . We show that $\mathcal{A}$ is an expected polynomial time adversary for $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{cm}, \Pi_{rok}]$ with success probability $\epsilon_{P^*} - \text{negl}(\lambda)$: Step 1 and 2 succeed with probability $\epsilon_{P^*} - \text{negl}(\lambda)$ by knowledge soundness of Π_{cp} and Π_{snark} . Therefore,

$$((\mathbb{z}_{cp}, (\mathbb{w}_{cp}, \mathbb{w}_e)) \in \mathcal{R}_{cp}) \quad \wedge \quad ((\mathbb{z}_o, \mathbb{w}_o) \in \mathcal{R}_o),$$

which implies that, with probability $\epsilon_{\mathcal{A}} := \epsilon_{\mathcal{P}^*} - \text{negl}(\lambda)$, the folding proof $[(c_{\text{fs},i})_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}, (m_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}]$ (for $\text{FS}^{\text{H}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$) is valid w.r.t. the input instance $\mathbf{x}$ and output instance $\mathbf{x}_o$, and $\mathbf{w}_o$ is a valid witness for $\mathbf{x}_o$ w.r.t. $\mathcal{R}_o$.

Let $\text{Ext}_{\text{rok}}^{\mathcal{A}}$ be the RoK extractor for $\text{FS}^{\text{H}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$ w.r.t. adversary $\mathcal{A}$. The SNARK extractor for Π^* simply runs $\text{Ext}_{\text{rok}}^{\mathcal{A}}$. By knowledge soundness of $\text{FS}^{\text{H}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{rok}}]$, with probability $\epsilon_{\mathcal{A}} - \text{negl}(\lambda)$, it outputs a valid witness $\mathbf{w}$ for $\mathbf{x}$ w.r.t. the relaxed relation $\mathcal{R}'$. $\square$

Scalable SNARKs from High-Arity Folding. By plugging the RoK Π_{fold} (Figure 4) and its Fiat-Shamir transform $\text{FS}^{\text{H}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{fold}}]$ (Section 5) into Construction 6.1, and instantiating Π_{cp} and Π_{snark} with SNARKs in the random oracle model (or algebraic group model if we use pairing-based SNARKs), we obtain the following corollary.

Corollary 6.2. *Let aux, aux' be the R1CS parameters defined in Theorem 4.1. For $\ell_{\text{np}} = \text{poly}(\lambda)$ that satisfies Eq. (51) in Theorem 4.1, there exists a SNARK (in the random oracle model) for relation $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ with relaxed relation $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'})^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$.*

Proposition 6.1. *Let $\mathbb{C}_{\text{FS}}$ and $\mathbb{C}_{\text{fold}}$ be the commitment domains used in the Fiat-Shamir heuristic and folding. The SNARK from Corollary 6.2 achieves:*

Prover time:

- Folding cost $T_p^{\text{fold}}(\ell_{\text{np}}, k_g, n, m)$ from Proposition 4.2.
- SNARK proving cost for Π_{cp} and Π_{snark} .
- Commitment cost (over $\mathbb{C}_{\text{FS}}$) for prover messages $m_1, \dots, m_{\text{rnd}}$.

Verifier time:

- SNARK verification for Π_{cp} and Π_{snark} .
- Fiat-Shamir transformation cost with transcript being $\log(n) + O(1)$ $\mathbb{C}_{\text{FS}}$ -elements and randomness $\Gamma_v^{\text{fold}}(\ell_{\text{np}}, k_g, n, m)$ from Proposition 4.2.

Proof size: $\log(n) + O(1)$ $\mathbb{C}_{\text{FS}}$ -elements, $1 + k_g$ $\mathbb{C}_{\text{fold}}$ -elements, $4 + k_g$ $\mathbb{E}$ -elements, n_{in} R_q -elements, and two SNARK proofs $\pi_{\text{cp}}, \pi_{\text{snark}}$.

7 Instantiation

Table 1 presents a candidate instantiation for the folding-based SNARKs in Corollary 6.2, with MSIS parameters set according to the lattice estimator [APS15] at 117-bit security. The sizes of the extension field $\mathbb{K}$ and the folding challenge set $\mathcal{S}$ are set to be larger than¹² 2^{128} . We leave the concrete implementation as future work, but we provide rough estimate for prover/verifier complexity and proof size to highlight its efficiency.

Prover complexity. The commitment opening relation is not embedded in the CP-SNARK circuit by definition. If we instantiate the SNARK Π_{snark} with a lattice-based scheme (e.g. [BS23; NS24]), the corresponding SNARK statement does not embed the lattice commitment opening relation either.

¹²We need to scale the set sizes by a factor of Q (the number of random oracle queries) to match the security bounds achieved by non-interactive folding schemes.

Variable	Description	Instantiation
q	prime modulus	64-bit prime
d	ring dimension & R1CS batching factor	64
κ	MSIS rank	12
β_{SIS}	ℓ_2 -norm bound for MSIS hardness	2^{37}
$\mathbb{K}$	extension field for sumcheck	$\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$
ℓ_{np}	folding arity	2^{10}
ℓ_h	projection input length	2^{14}
λ_{pj}	projection output length	2^8
$\bar{n}$	R1CS witness length per instance	2^{16}
m	number of R1CS constraints per instance	2^{16}
k_{cs}	decomposition factor for R1CS witnesses	16
b	decomposition base for R1CS witnesses	2^4
n	generalized R1CS witness length	$\bar{n}k_{\text{cs}} = 2^{20}$
$\mathcal{S}$	folding challenge set	as in [BS23]
B_{rbnd}	norm bound for relaxed openings	$\beta_{\text{SIS}}/(4\ \mathcal{S}\ _{\text{op}}) \approx 2^{31}$
B_{bnd}	norm bound for strict openings s.t. Eq. (51) holds	$B_{\text{rbnd}}/2 = 2^{30}$
k_g	number of monomial vectors in the range proof	3
B_{d,k_g}	ℓ_∞ -norm bound for range proof	121117 (Eq. (28))
B	input witness norm bound, $0.5b\sqrt{\ell_h} \leq B \leq B_{d,k_g}/9.5$	2^{10}
B'	relaxed input norm bound, $16B_{d,k_g}/\sqrt{30} \leq B' \leq \beta_{\text{SIS}}/(\sqrt{nd/\ell_h})$	353806

Table 1: Parameters and candidate instantiations

By Proposition 4.2, the CP-SNARK circuit is dominated by the folding verifier cost $T_v^{\text{fold}}(\ell_{\text{np}}, n_{\text{in}}, k_g, n, m)$. Under Table 1 parameters, this requires about $2^{16} \sim 2^{17}$ multiplications between $\mathcal{S}$ and R_q .

The SNARK circuit for Π_{snark} , defined by $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$, is dominated by k_g inner products between $\mathcal{M}^n$ and $\mathbb{K}^n$ (Eq. (27)), 3 inner products between R_q^m and $\mathbb{K}^m$, and 1 inner product between $R_q^{m_J}$ and $\mathbb{K}^{m_J}$, where $m_J := n\lambda_{\text{pj}}/\ell_h$. With Table 1 parameters, this is about 2^{25} constraints over field $\mathbb{Z}_q$. Effectively, they are just 7 polynomial evaluation proofs, whose structure might enable more direct and efficient constructions.

By Proposition 6.1, the proving cost is dominated by the high-arity folding scheme, whose cost is dominated by the committing cost for input witnesses. Under Table 1, this is $\kappa n \ell_{\text{np}} = 3 \cdot 2^{32}$ multiplications between arbitrary R_q -elements and bounded elements (with ℓ_∞ -norm at most $0.5b = 8$).

Overall, with the proving cost above, we can batchly prove $\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot d = 2^{16}$ R1CS statements over $\mathbb{Z}_q$, each with 2^{16} constraints. This is about 2^{32} total R1CS constraints.

Remark 7.1. When the original R1CS witness already has a low-norm (e.g., in large language models), the decomposition factor k_{cs} can be smaller, leading to further speedup. For example, if the witness consists of 8-bit signed integers, we obtain an extra 8x speedup.

Proof size. For simplicity, assume the public input length $n_{\text{in}} = 0$. By Proposition 6.1, with Table 1 parameters, the proof size is dominated by two SNARK proofs, 4 elements over R_q^κ , and 7 elements over $\mathbb{E}$. The most succinct post-quantum SNARKs (e.g. WHIR [ACFY25], LaBRADOR [BS23]) have proof sizes in range 50-100KB. Thus, we estimate the proof size to be below 200KB. When post-quantum security is not needed, we can use pairing-based SNARKs such as Hyperplonk+KZG [CBBZ23], which leads to a proof size below 50KB.

Verifier complexity. By Proposition 6.1, the verifier is dominated by the two SNARK verifications and the Fiat-Shamir transform. With Table 1 parameters, the Fiat-Shamir randomness is dominated by the random projection matrix that requires no more than $2 \cdot \ell_h \cdot \lambda_{\text{pj}} = 2^{23}$ random bits ($\approx 1\text{MB}$). Generating this randomness with a standardized hash function such as SHA-3 typically takes less than a millisecond.

8 Two-layer Folding by Splitting Linear Statements

In this section, under a slightly stronger MSIS assumption, we reduce a generic linear statement of witness size $n = n' \cdot \ell$ into ℓ generic linear statements, each with witness size n' . Here both n' and ℓ are powers-of-two. As shown in Section 1.2, this reduction allows us to further split Π_{fold} 's (Figure 4) output statement (that lies in the linear relation $\mathcal{R}_o := \mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$) into multiple uniform linear statements, so that we can apply the high-arity folding scheme again.

Let $\mathfrak{i} := (\mathbf{A}, R_q, \mathbb{K}, \mathbb{E})$ be the index defined in Eq. (20). We further assume that the MSIS matrix $\mathbf{A} \in R_q^{\kappa \times n}$ has the structure

$$\mathbf{A} = [r_1 \cdot \mathbf{A}', \dots, r_\ell \cdot \mathbf{A}'] \quad (57)$$

for some random $r_1, \dots, r_\ell \leftarrow \$ R_q$ and $\mathbf{A}' \leftarrow \$ R_q^{\kappa \times n'}$.

Consider parameter $\text{aux} := (n_{\text{in}} \in \mathbb{N}, (\mathbf{M}_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m_i \times n})_{i=1}^{k_x})$ and a generic linear relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$ defined in Eq. (21). Our goal is to reduce a statement in $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$ into multiple statements in a simpler linear relation. For simplicity, we assume $n_{\text{in}} = 0$, $k_x = 1$ and denote $\mathbf{M} := \mathbf{M}_1$. Our approach naturally extends to the general case.

WLOG, assume that $\mathbf{M} \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{(m' \ell) \times (n' \ell)}$ is of the form $\mathbf{M} = \mathbf{I}_\ell \otimes \mathbf{M}'$ for some $\mathbf{M}' \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m' \times n'}$, where m' is a power-of-two. (Looking ahead, in our two-layer folding-based SNARK, $\mathbf{M}'$ will correspond to a R1CS (or projection) matrix for the 2nd-layer witnesses, which can no longer be split.) We can write $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$ as

$$\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}} := \left\{ (\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{x} = (c \in \mathbb{C}, (\mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log \ell}, \mathbf{s} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log m'}), v \in \mathbb{E}) \\ \mathfrak{w} = \mathbf{f} := (\mathbf{f}_1, \dots, \mathbf{f}_\ell) \in R_q^{n' \ell} \text{ s.t.} \\ \text{VfyOpen}(\text{pp}_{\text{cm}}, c, \mathbf{f}) = 1 \wedge \langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{r} || \mathbf{s}), \mathbf{M}\mathbf{f} \rangle = v \end{array} \right\}. \quad (58)$$

Define relation

$$\mathcal{R}' := \left\{ (\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{w}) : \begin{array}{l} \mathfrak{x} = (c \in \mathbb{C}, \mathbf{s} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log m'}, v \in \mathbb{E}) \\ \mathfrak{w} = \mathbf{f} \in R_q^{n'} \text{ s.t.} \\ \text{VfyOpen}(\mathbf{A}', c, \mathbf{f}) = 1 \wedge \langle \text{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{M}'\mathbf{f} \rangle = v \end{array} \right\}. \quad (59)$$

A statement $(\mathbf{z}, \mathbf{w}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}}$ can be reduced to ℓ statements in $\mathcal{R}'$ via the following reduction of knowledge:

1. $\mathbf{P} \rightarrow \mathbf{V}$: For all $i \in [\ell]$, send $c_i := \mathbf{A}' \mathbf{f}_i$ and $v_i := \langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{s}), \mathbf{M}' \mathbf{f}_i \rangle$
2. $\mathbf{V}$: Check that $c = \sum_{i=1}^{\ell} r_i \cdot c_i$ and $\langle \mathbf{ts}(\mathbf{r}), (v_1, \dots, v_{\ell}) \rangle = v$. Abort if it fails
3. $\mathbf{V}$: For all $i \in [\ell]$, output $\mathbf{z}_i = (c_i, \mathbf{s}, v_i)$
4. $\mathbf{P}$: For all $i \in [\ell]$, output $\mathbf{w}_i = \mathbf{f}_i$

Two-layer folding. Using the splitting RoK above, we describe a two-layer folding-based SNARK that batch-proves $\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot \ell$ statements in the generalized R1CS relation (Eq. (37)).

- Each individual statement has witness length n' and R1CS matrices $(\mathbf{M}'_i \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{m' \times n'})_{i=1}^3$. In the 1st layer, every ℓ consecutive witness vectors $(\mathbf{f}_1, \dots, \mathbf{f}_{\ell})$ is packed into a single witness vector. The MSIS matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is defined as in Eq. (57) and for $i \in [3]$, the R1CS matrix $\mathbf{M}_i$ is set to $\mathbf{M}_i := \mathbf{I}_{\ell} \otimes \mathbf{M}'_i$.
- Let $\mathcal{R}_o := \mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$, and define $\mathcal{R}'_o$ as identical to $\mathcal{R}_o$ except that (i) each witness has length n' instead of $n' \cdot \ell$, (ii) the MSIS matrix becomes $\mathbf{A}'$, and (iii) $(\mathbf{M}_i = \mathbf{I}_{\ell} \otimes \mathbf{M}'_i)_i$ are replaced with $(\mathbf{M}'_i)_i$. After finishing the 1st-layer folding, we split the folded statement $(\mathbf{z}_o, \mathbf{w}_o) \in \mathcal{R}_o$ into ℓ linear statements in $\mathcal{R}'_o$ using the splitting RoK above.
- The witnesses of the ℓ linear statements may have relatively large norms after the 1st-layer folding. Directly folding them in the 2nd layer would require larger moduli or higher lattice dimensions. To address this, we use the decomposition RoK from [BC24; BC25] to reduce the ℓ statements into $\ell \cdot k_b$ statements with much lower norms. In practice, $k_b \leq 4$ suffices. Now, each of the $\ell \cdot k_b$ statements lies in $\mathcal{R}'$, which is almost identical to $\mathcal{R}'_o$ except that the commitment opening check $\text{VfyOpen}(\cdot)$ is replaced with a more fine-grained check $\text{VfyOpen}_{\ell_h, B'}(\cdot)$ for a lower norm bound B' .
- Given the $\ell \cdot k_b$ linear statements in $\mathcal{R}'$, we use the high-arity folding scheme and the commit-and-prove compiler again to compress them into a CP-SNARK proof and a SNARK proof. Since the input statements are already linear, the high-arity folding scheme does not need to run the Hadamard protocol (Figure 1). Moreover, in addition to the folding-verifier logic, the CP-SNARK relation also ensures that the verifier checks in both the splitting RoK and the decomposition RoK pass. With the commit-and-prove technique, the CP-SNARK circuits only checks linear combinations, not the Fiat-Shamir heuristic or commitment opening relations.

Compared to the single-layer folding-based SNARK, the CP-SNARK statements in the two-layer scheme only checks $O(\ell_{\text{np}} + \ell)$ R_q -multiplications, rather than $O(\ell_{\text{np}} \cdot \ell)$ multiplications as in the single-layer scheme. The norm blowup is also significantly smaller,

enabling smaller moduli and lower lattice dimensions. As a tradeoff, the two-layer scheme relies on a slightly stronger assumption where the MSIS assumption holds even if the matrix $\mathbf{A}$ has the form of Eq. (57). Furthermore, although most 1st-layer sub-protocols remain memory-efficient and streaming-friendly, the sumchecks become ℓ -times larger. Naively running them would incur either high computational cost or high memory cost. Fortunately, again, we can use the technique from Section 4 of [Baw+25] to run the sumcheck prover in time $O(n'\ell \log \log(n'\ell))$, space $O((n'\ell)^{1/k})$ with $O(k + \log \log(n'\ell))$ passes over the input data.

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A The Monomial RoK from LatticeFold+

We present a reduction of knowledge from the monomial relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{mon},k_g}$ (Eq. (26)) to the linear relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin},k_g}$ (Eq. (27)). It simplifies [BC25, Construction 4.2] by removing the double commitments. We set the batching parameter k_g to 1 for brevity, but the protocol naturally extends to $k_g > 1$.

We first recall some useful notation: For $a = \sum_{i=1}^d a_i X^{i-1} \in R_q$, and a value $\beta \in \mathbb{K} = \mathbb{F}_{q^t}$, let $\hat{a}(X) \in \mathbb{Z}_q[X] \subseteq \mathbb{K}[X]$ be the canonical mapping from R_q to $\mathbb{K}[X]$. We define $\mathbf{ev}_a(\beta) := \sum_{i=1}^d a_i \beta^{i-1} \in \mathbb{K}$ as the evaluation of $\hat{a}(X)$ at $\beta \in \mathbb{K}$. More generally, for $\beta \in \mathbb{K}$ and a matrix $\mathbf{e} \in \mathbb{E}$ with columns $[\mathbf{e}_1, \dots, \mathbf{e}_d] \in \mathbb{K}^d$, let $\hat{\mathbf{e}}(X) = \sum_{i=1}^d \mathbf{e}_i \cdot X^{i-1} \in \mathbb{K}[X]$ be the canonical mapping from $\mathbb{E}$ to $\mathbb{K}[X]$. We define $\mathbf{ev}_{\mathbf{e}}(\beta) = \sum_{i=1}^d \mathbf{e}_i \cdot \beta^{i-1} \in \mathbb{K}$ as the evaluation of $\hat{\mathbf{e}}(X)$ at $\beta \in \mathbb{K}$.

Before presenting the protocol, we recall a useful lemma from [BC25], which states that a random test is sufficient to check whether a polynomial is a monomial.

Lemma A.1 (Corollary 4.1 [BC25]). *Fix $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{F}_{q^t}$ and a prime $q > 2$. For all $a \in \mathcal{M} \subseteq R_q$ and $\beta \in \mathbb{K}$, we have $\mathbf{ev}_a(\beta)^2 = \mathbf{ev}_a(\beta^2)$. And for every $a \in R_q$ not in $\mathcal{M}$,*

$$\Pr_{\beta \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{K}} [\mathbf{ev}_a(\beta)^2 = \mathbf{ev}_a(\beta^2)] < 2d/|\mathbb{K}|.$$

From the above lemma, verifying that a committed vector $\mathbf{g} \in R_q^n$ contains only monomials reduces to checking the identity $\mathbf{ev}_{\mathbf{g}_i}(\beta)^2 = \mathbf{ev}_{\mathbf{g}_i}(\beta^2)$ for all $i \in [n]$ at a random point $\beta \in \mathbb{K}$. To do this efficiently, we convert these n equations into a single sumcheck claim via a random linear combination. Running the sumcheck protocol then reduce this claim to a linear evaluation statement. We present the formal protocol below:

Input: $\mathbf{x} = c \in \mathbb{C}$ and $\mathbf{w} = \mathbf{g} \in R_q^n$ such that $(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{mon},1}$

Output: $\mathbf{x}_o = (\mathbf{r} \in \mathbb{K}^{\log n}, c \in \mathbb{C}, \mathbf{u} \in \mathbb{E})$ and $\mathbf{w}_o = \mathbf{g} \in R_q^n$ such that $(\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin},1}$

1. $\mathbf{V} \rightarrow \mathbf{P}$: Send challenges $\mathbf{c} \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{K}^{\log n}$ and $\beta \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{K}$.
2. $\mathbf{P} \leftrightarrow \mathbf{V}$: Define vectors

$$\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{g},\beta} := (\mathbf{ev}_{\mathbf{g}_1}(\beta), \dots, \mathbf{ev}_{\mathbf{g}_n}(\beta)) \in \mathbb{K}^n, \quad \mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{g},\beta^2} := (\mathbf{ev}_{\mathbf{g}_1}(\beta^2), \dots, \mathbf{ev}_{\mathbf{g}_n}(\beta^2)) \in \mathbb{K}^n$$

and let $\widetilde{\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{g},\beta}}, \widetilde{\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{g},\beta^2}}$ be their multilinear extensions. Run a sumcheck protocol for the claim

$$\sum_{\mathbf{b} \in \{0,1\}^{\log n}} eq(\mathbf{c}, \mathbf{b}) \cdot (\widetilde{\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{g},\beta}}(\mathbf{b})^2 - \widetilde{\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{g},\beta^2}}(\mathbf{b})) = 0. \quad (60)$$

Let $\mathbf{r} \xleftarrow{\mathbb{R}} \mathbb{K}^{\log n}$ be the sumcheck challenge and $v \in \mathbb{K}$ be the claimed evaluation. The protocol reduces the sumcheck claim to an evaluation statement:

$$eq(\mathbf{c}, \mathbf{r}) \cdot (\widetilde{\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{g},\beta}}(\mathbf{r})^2 - \widetilde{\mathbf{v}_{\mathbf{g},\beta^2}}(\mathbf{r})) \stackrel{?}{=} v.$$

3. $P \rightarrow V$: Send $\mathbf{u} = \widetilde{\mathbf{g}}(\mathbf{r}) = \langle \mathbf{g}, \text{ts}(\mathbf{r}) \rangle \in \mathbb{E}$

4. V : Check that:

$$eq(\mathbf{c}, \mathbf{r}) \cdot (\mathbf{ev}_{\mathbf{u}}(\beta)^2 - \mathbf{ev}_{\mathbf{u}}(\beta^2)) \stackrel{?}{=} v, \quad (61)$$

Abort and return $\perp$ if the check fails.

5. Return the reduced statement $(\mathbf{x}_o = (\mathbf{r}, c, \mathbf{u}), \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{g}) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, 1}$.

B Proof of Theorem 5.1

The completeness proof is identical to that of Theorem 4.1. We focus on the knowledge soundness proof.

We first review a variant of Lemma 2.3 in the random oracle model, adapted from Section 8.2 and Figure 13 of [FMN24]. For ease of exposition, we assume that there are two random oracles H, H_{fd} , where $H_{\text{fd}} : \{0, 1\}^L \rightarrow \mathcal{S}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ is used to sample the folding challenge β given the L -bit transcript prefix, while H is used to generate other verifier challenges. In practice, one can use a single hash function to instantiate both H and H_{fd} via domain separation.

Lemma B.1 ([FMN24], Section 8.2). *Define $\mathcal{U} := \mathcal{S}^\ell$, output space $\mathcal{Y}$, predicate $\Psi : \mathcal{U} \times \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$ as in Lemma 2.3. Define $\text{prefix}_L : \{0, 1\}^* \rightarrow \{0, 1\}^L$ as the function that outputs the first L bits of its input. Let H and $H_{\text{fd}} : \{0, 1\}^L \rightarrow \mathcal{S}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ be random oracles.*

For every oracle algorithm¹³ $\mathcal{A}^{H, H_{\text{fd}}}$ making at most Q oracle queries and outputting $y \in \mathcal{Y}$, define

$$\epsilon_\Psi(\mathcal{A}) := \Pr[y \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{H, H_{\text{fd}}}, u := H_{\text{fd}}(\text{prefix}_L(y)) : \Psi(u, y) = 1],$$

where the randomness is over the random oracles.

There exists an oracle algorithm $\mathcal{E}^{\mathcal{A}}$, which invokes $\mathcal{A}$ at most $1 + \ell$ times in expectation, such that with probability at least

$$\epsilon_\Psi(\mathcal{A}) - (Q + 1) \cdot \ell / |\mathcal{S}|, \quad (62)$$

it outputs a tuple $(y_L \in \{0, 1\}^L, (\mathbf{u}_i, y_{R,i})_{i=0}^\ell)$ satisfying that (i) $\mathbf{u}_i \equiv_i \mathbf{u}_0$ for all $i \in [\ell]$, and (ii) for all $i \in [0, \ell]$:

$$(\Psi(\mathbf{u}_i, y_i := (y_L, y_{R,i})) = 1) \wedge (y_i = \mathcal{A}^{H, H_{\text{fd}}[y_L, \mathbf{u}_i]}).$$

Here, $H_{\text{fd}}[y_L, \mathbf{u}_0] = H_{\text{fd}}$ is the original sampled oracle, and $H_{\text{fd}}[y_L, \mathbf{u}_i]$ ($1 \leq i \leq \ell$) denotes the programmed oracle of H_{fd} where $H_{\text{fd}}(y_L) := \mathbf{u}_i$.

¹³WLOG, assume that $\mathcal{A}$ has no internal randomness, as we can convert a randomized $\mathcal{A}$ into a deterministic one (by choosing the optimal randomness) such that $\epsilon_\Psi(\mathcal{A})$ does not decrease.

We also need a non-interactive variant of [Lemma 4.1](#) in the random oracle model. The proof is non-trivial, because compared to the proof of [Lemma 4.1](#), we can no longer use the soundness of the *interactive* sumcheck protocol to argue the soundness of the Fiat-Shamir transformed protocol.

Our proof relies on the notion of **round-by-round soundness** [[Can+19](#); [CMS19](#)]. A protocol is round-by-round sound if there is a state function over partial transcripts such that (i) if the instance x is not in the language, then the initial state is doomed; (ii) in each round, if the current transcript is in a doomed state, then for any next prover message, with overwhelming probability over the verifier's challenge, the next state will still be doomed; and (iii) if the final state w.r.t. the entire transcript is doomed, the verifier rejects.

Next, we show that $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{gr1cs}}]$ is a non-interactive RoK from the R1CS relation to the target linear relation. Here, it suffices to prove adaptive soundness as the input witness can be derived from the output witness. The key idea is to reduce the soundness of the non-interactive scheme to the round-by-round soundness of the interactive protocol. Specifically, we construct an adversary $\mathcal{A}'$ that simulates the interactive protocol by extracting prover messages from the random oracle queries made by adversary $\mathcal{A}$ for $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{gr1cs}}]$.

Lemma B.2. *Define parameters aux , aux' as in [Lemma 4.1](#). Let Π_{gr1cs} be the RoK in [Figure 3](#). Let Π_{cm} be a binding commitment scheme that is further straightline extractable. Let H be a hash function modeled as a random oracle. $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{gr1cs}}]$ is an RoK from $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}}$ (Eq. (37)) to $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{aux}_{\text{cs}}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$, with the relaxed input relation $\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'}$. Here, $\mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ is from Eq. (27) and aux_{cs} is defined in Eq. (45).*

Proof. Let Π'_{gr1cs} be the interactive proof version of Π_{gr1cs} (where every instance and prover commitment also attaches a message opening). As shown in [[Can+19](#); [CMS19](#)], sumcheck protocols are *round-by-round sound*. Thus, it is straightforward to argue that Π'_{gr1cs} is also round-by-round sound. Let State , $\epsilon_{\text{rbr}} = \text{negl}(\lambda)$ be the state function and round-by-round soundness error of Π'_{gr1cs} .

Next, we reduce the adaptive soundness of $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{gr1cs}}]$ to the round-by-round soundness of Π'_{gr1cs} and the security of Π_{cm} . Suppose for contradiction that a cheating PPT prover $\mathcal{A}$ for $\text{FS}^H[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{gr1cs}}]$, with non-negligible probability ϵ , outputs an instance x and a tuple $(\text{tr}, (x_o, w_o))$ such that (i) $(x_o, w_o) \in \mathcal{R}_o$ is the output instance-witness pair, (ii) x and the witness opening w (deterministically derived from w_o) is not in the input relation, and (iii) $\text{tr} = [(c_{\text{fs}, i})_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}, (r_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}+1}, (m_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}]$ is an accepting transcript, where $(c_{\text{fs}, i})_i$ are the round commitments, $(r_i)_i$ are the hashed challenges, and $(m_i)_i$ are the opening prover messages. Note that w_o also includes valid openings $(g^{(i)} \in \mathcal{M}^n)_{i=1}^{k_g}$ to the prover commitments $(c^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$ sent in Π_{gr1cs} .

From $\mathcal{A}$, we obtain a cheating PPT prover $\mathcal{A}'$ with same success probability. The adversary $\mathcal{A}'$ simply simulates the execution of $\mathcal{A}$ and for each prover commitment $c^{(i)}$ ($i \in [k_g]$) included in prover message m_1 , $\mathcal{A}'$ also attaches the corresponding opening $g^{(i)}$ from w_o . Let m'_1 denote the updated message. We say that $\mathcal{A}'$ succeeds if $\mathcal{A}$ succeeds and $[(x, w), (r_1|m'_1|r_2|m_2| \dots |m_{\text{rnd}}|r_{\text{rnd}+1}), (x_o, w_o)]$ is a valid transcript for Π'_{gr1cs} .

By the binding property of Π_{cm} and the definition of round-by-round soundness, either we break the binding of Π_{cm} , or there is an index $i \in [\text{rnd}]$, such that with probability at least $\epsilon' = (\epsilon - \text{negl}(\lambda))/\text{rnd}$, the output of $\mathcal{A}'$ satisfies that

$$\text{State}((\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w}), \text{tr}_i) = \text{reject} \quad \text{and} \quad \text{State}((\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{w}), \text{tr}_{i+1}) = \text{accept}, \quad (63)$$

where $\text{tr}_i := (r_1|m'_1|r_2|m_2|\dots|m_{i-1}|r_i)$ and $\text{tr}_{i+1} := (r_1|m'_1|r_2|m_2|\dots|r_i|m_i|r_{i+1})$. We argue that ϵ' is at most $\approx Q \cdot \epsilon_{\text{rbr}} = \text{negl}(\lambda)$, contradicting with the assumption that ϵ is non-negligible.

Claim 1. $\epsilon' \leq Q \cdot (\epsilon_{\text{rbr}} + \text{negl}(\lambda))$.

Proof. Note that $\mathcal{A}$ above must have queried $\mathbf{H}$ on input $(r_1|c_{\text{fs},1}|\dots|r_i|c_{\text{fs},i})$, otherwise it can never predict r_{i+1} with non-negligible probability. WLOG, we assume $\mathcal{A}$ always outputs the same input instance $\mathbf{x}$. Given index i , and the Q -query adversary $\mathcal{A}$, consider a mental experiment as follows: (The experiment can be simulated in polynomial time.)

1. Simulate the execution of $\mathcal{A}$ until it succeeds. Let $\mathbf{w}$ be the input witness deterministically derived from the vector $\mathbf{f} \in R_q^n$ in the output witness $\mathbf{w}_o$
2. Sample a query index $q \leftarrow_{\$} [Q]$
3. Simulate the execution of $\mathcal{A}$ again with fresh randomness. Given the q th oracle query input s , the experiment aborts if s has been queried before or s is not of the form $(r_1|c_{\text{fs},1}|\dots|r_i|c_{\text{fs},i})$; otherwise, it extracts the message m_j underlying $c_{\text{fs},j}$ for $j \in [i]$
4. Given challenge r_1 (that includes random projection matrix $\mathbf{J}$), compute the monomial vectors $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$ from the projected matrix $(\mathbf{I}_{n/\ell_h} \otimes \mathbf{J}) \times \text{cf}(\mathbf{f})$ and attach $(\mathbf{g}^{(i)})_{i=1}^{k_g}$ into m_1 to obtain updated message m'_1
5. Sample uniformly random r_{i+1} afterward¹⁴
6. Outputs 1 if and only if Eq. (63) holds w.r.t. $\text{tr}_i := (r_1|m'_1|r_2|m_2|\dots|m_{i-1}|r_i)$ and $\text{tr}_{i+1} := (r_1|m'_1|r_2|m_2|\dots|r_i|m_i|r_{i+1})$

By definition of round-by-round soundness, the success probability of the experiment is at most ϵ_{rbr} . On the other hand, by definition of ϵ' and the binding property of the lattice commitment, the experiment outputs 1 with probability at least $\epsilon'/Q - \text{negl}(\lambda)$. Thus, $\epsilon' \leq Q \cdot (\epsilon_{\text{rbr}} + \text{negl}(\lambda))$ as desired. $\square$

In sum, $\mathcal{A}$'s success probability ϵ must be negligible, and thus $\text{FS}^{\text{H}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{gr1cs}}]$ is adaptively sound. This also implies knowledge soundness as the extracted witness opening is deterministically derived from the adversary's output. $\square$

¹⁴It is important to sample r_{i+1} after extracting m'_1 and $(m_j)_{j=2}^i$, otherwise r_{i+1} may be correlated with the prover messages.

Remark B.1. The straightline extractability requirement of Π_{cm} seems to be a proof artifact. We conjecture that the binding property suffices and leave it as an open problem.

Next, equipped with [Lemma B.1](#) and [Lemma B.2](#), we prove the knowledge soundness of $\text{FS}^{\text{H}, \text{H}_{\text{fd}}}[\Pi_{\text{cm}}, \Pi_{\text{fold}}]$.

Knowledge soundness. We first describe the extractor. WLOG, assume that the adversary P^* is deterministic. Define folding challenge space $\mathcal{U} := \mathcal{S}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$. Let $\mathcal{Y}$ be the domain of $(\pi, (\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o))$ where $(\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o)$ is the output instance-witness pair, and $\pi = [(c_{\text{fs}, i}, m_i)_{i=1}^{\text{rnd}}]$ is the folding proof where $c_{\text{fs}, i}$'s are the round commitments and m_i 's are the opening prover messages. Define predicate $\Psi(\mathbf{u} \in \mathcal{U}, \mathbf{y} := (\pi, (\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o)))$ that outputs 1 if and only if (i) π is an accepting proof (with derived folding challenge $\beta = \mathbf{u}$) and (ii) $(\mathbf{x}_o, \mathbf{w}_o) \in \mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$. For folding challenge $\mathbf{u}$ and the extra verifier randomness $\mathbf{r}_v$, define $\mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}(\mathbf{u})$ as the adversary that simulates the execution of P^* with verifier randomness $\mathbf{r}_v$ and folding challenge $\mathbf{u}$. Let Ext_{cwss} be the oracle extractor from [Lemma B.1](#).

Extractor $\text{Ext}^{\mathcal{A}^*}$:

1. Sample folding challenge $\mathbf{u}_0 \leftarrow \mathcal{S}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ and extra verifier randomness $\mathbf{r}_v$
2. Run extractor $\text{Ext}_{\text{cwss}}^{\mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}(\mathbf{u}_0)}$. Abort if it fails. Otherwise, let the output be

$$\left(\mathbf{u}_\ell, \mathbf{y}_\ell := (\pi_\ell, \mathbf{x}_o^\ell, \mathbf{w}_o^\ell) \right)_{\ell=0}^{\ell_{\text{np}}},$$

where for all $\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$, $\mathbf{u}_\ell \equiv_\ell \mathbf{u}_0$ and

$$(\Psi(\mathbf{u}_\ell, \mathbf{y}_\ell := (y_L, y_{R, \ell})) = 1) \wedge (y_\ell = \mathcal{A}^{\text{H}, \text{H}_{\text{fd}}[y_L, \mathbf{u}_\ell]}).$$

3. For every $\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$, parse $\mathbf{w}_o^\ell = (\mathbf{f}^{*, \ell}, (\mathbf{g}^{(i, \ell)})_{i=1}^{k_g})$, compute

$$\mathbf{f}^\ell := (\mathbf{f}^{*, \ell} - \mathbf{f}^{*, 0}) / (\mathbf{u}_\ell[\ell] - \mathbf{u}_0[\ell]) \in R_q^n, \quad (64)$$

$$\forall i \in [k_g] : \mathbf{h}^{i, \ell} := (\mathbf{g}^{(i, \ell)} - \mathbf{g}^{(i, 0)}) / (\mathbf{u}_\ell[\ell] - \mathbf{u}_0[\ell]) \in R_q^n \quad (65)$$

Parse $\mathbf{f}^\ell$ as $\mathbf{f}^\ell := \text{cf}^{-1}([\mathbf{X}^{\ell \top}, \mathbf{W}^{\ell \top}]^\top) \in R_q^n$, abort if $\mathbf{X}^\ell \neq \mathbf{X}_{\text{in}}^\ell$

4. Output $\mathbf{w} := \{\mathbf{w}_\ell = \mathbf{W}^\ell \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n_w \times d}\}_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$

Success probability. Fix verifier randomness $\mathbf{r}_v$ (that excludes folding challenge β). By [Lemma B.1](#), Step 2 succeeds with probability $\epsilon_\Psi(\mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}) - (Q + 1) \cdot \ell_{\text{np}} / |\mathcal{S}|$ where

$$\epsilon_\Psi(\mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}) := \Pr[y \leftarrow \mathcal{A}_{\mathbf{r}_v}^{\text{H}, \text{H}_{\text{fd}}}, u := \text{H}_{\text{fd}}(\text{prefix}_L(y)) : \Psi(u, y) = 1].$$

Let $(c_\ell)_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ denote the input commitments and $(c_\ell^{(i)})_{i \in [k_g], \ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]}$ the monomial commitments. The extracted openings $(\mathbf{f}^\ell, (\mathbf{h}^{i, \ell})_{i=1}^{k_g})_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ satisfy:

- For $\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$, $\mathbf{f}^\ell$ is bound to c_ℓ , with relaxed opening $(\mathbf{f}^{*, \ell} - \mathbf{f}^{*, 0}, \mathbf{u}_\ell[\ell] - \mathbf{u}_0[\ell])$ (Eq. [\(10\)](#)).

- For $i \in [k_g], \ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$, $\mathbf{h}^{i,\ell}$ is bound to $c_\ell^{(i)}$, with opening $(\mathbf{g}^{(i,\ell)} - \mathbf{g}^{(i,0)}, \mathbf{u}_\ell[\ell] - \mathbf{u}_0[\ell])$.
- For $\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]$, let $\mathbf{x}_{o,\ell}$ be the reduced instance from Eq. (47), and set $\mathbf{w}_{o,\ell} := (\mathbf{f}^\ell, (\mathbf{h}^{i,\ell})_{i=1}^{k_g})_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$. Define $\hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}}, \hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{batchlin}}$ as the relaxed relations of $\mathcal{R}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}}, \mathcal{R}_{\text{batchlin}, k_g}$ where the strict opening check VfyOpen is replaced with the relaxed ones from Eq. (10). Since $\Psi(\mathbf{u}_\ell, \mathbf{y}_\ell) = \Psi(\mathbf{u}_0, \mathbf{y}_0) = 1$, and $\mathbf{u}_\ell \equiv_\ell \mathbf{u}_0$, we get that $(\mathbf{x}_{o,\ell}, \mathbf{w}_{o,\ell}) \in \hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{batchlin}}$.

Let ϵ_{P^*} be the prover P^* 's success probability. Thus, with probability at least $\epsilon_{\text{P}^*} - ((Q + 1) \cdot \ell_{\text{np}}/|\mathcal{S}|)$ (where the randomness is over $\mathbf{r}_v, \mathbf{u}_0, \mathbf{H}, \mathbf{H}_{\text{fd}}$, and Ext_{cws}), the extractor outputs $(\mathbf{w}_{o,\ell})_{\ell \in [\ell_{\text{np}}]}$ at Step 3 satisfying the relaxed relation $(\hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{lin}}^{\text{auxcs}} \times \hat{\mathcal{R}}_{\text{batchlin}})_{\ell_{\text{np}}}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ w.r.t. $(\mathbf{x}_{o,\ell})_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$. By the same soundness argument as Lemma B.2 (relying on relaxed binding, Eq. (10), instead of strict binding, Eq. (11), of Construction 2.1), and by a union bound, the extractor succeeds with probability

$$\epsilon_{\text{P}^*} - ((Q + 1) \cdot \ell_{\text{np}}/|\mathcal{S}|) - \ell_{\text{np}} \cdot Q \cdot \text{negl}(\lambda) = \epsilon_{\text{P}^*} - \text{negl}(\lambda),$$

and produces a witness $\mathbf{w} := \{\mathbf{w}_\ell = \mathbf{W}^\ell\}_{\ell=1}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ in $(\mathcal{R}_{\text{gr1cs}}^{\text{aux}'})_{\ell_{\text{np}}}^{\ell_{\text{np}}}$ as required. $\square$